



How Europe Wins

EFA26: 24 August to 4 September 2026

Your personal schedule for:

Version: 16 Aug 2026

24.08.2026 18:00 - 24.08.2026 19:30 | Stage | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Welcome of Scholarship Holders

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

The European Forum Alpbach 2026 kick-off for scholarship holders and participants of the Alpbach Academy Days: Meet your peers, and inform yourself about everything you need to know to successfully navigate through the days ahead.

Karas, Othmar: President (European Forum Alpbach)

McGuinness, Mairéad: EU Special Envoy for the Promotion of Freedom (FoRB) of Religion or Belief (European Commission)

24.08.2026 20:00 - 24.08.2026 21:00 | Happening | CCA – Otto Molden Foyer

Scavenger Hunt

Hosted by: Forum Alpbach Network Committee

Discover Alpbach together! Join a scavenger hunt in groups of up to ten and take on a shared challenge along the way. Creative and humorous answers are highly encouraged – the most original contributions will be showcased during the International Evening.

//INFO: The scavenger hunt should not take more than an hour. It will start after the welcome drinks reception at the Otto-Molden-Foyer.

24.08.2026 21:00 - 24.08.2026 22:00 | Happening | Sportanlage Alpbach – Football Field

FANC – EFA26 Welcome Party – Football Court

Hosted by: Forum Alpbach Network Committee

Letting go after the formalities! You've gotten to know a bit of Alpbach and made some new friends; now it's time to break the ice with hundreds of new friends from around the world. Music, drinks, and food will liven up the occasion.

25.08.2026 08:15 - 25.08.2026 09:00 | Ritual | Mittelschule – Forecourt

Sunrise Bonding

Hosted by: Forum Alpbach Network Committee

Finding a bit of peace and quiet before EFA's vibrant vibes take over.

25.08.2026 09:30 - 25.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | CCA – Rogger-Saal

Examining EU Security: Shaping Europe's Next Security Strategy

Track: Studio

Europe's security landscape is changing rapidly, existing strategies no longer reflect today's geopolitical realities. In this Studio, participants will analyse what is needed for Europe to remain relevant, develop their priorities as future leaders as an input for a renewed EU Security Strategy in formulating concrete policy proposals. If you are ready to think outside the box, you have found your event.

Broomé, Ludvig: Analyst at the Europe Programme (The Swedish Institute of International Affairs)

Reiterer, Michael: Professor (Centre for Security, Diplomacy and Strategy, Brussels School of Governance, VUB)

25.08.2026 09:30 - 25.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 4

Geoeconomics and International Trade Policy

Track: Finance, Seminar

The rules-based international order is under pressure: protectionism and the strategic use of economic policy instruments are reshaping global politics and trade. This seminar explores the rise of geo-economics and examines how states use economic tools to pursue political objectives. Participants will discuss the implications for Europe's open and interconnected economy.

Kamin, Katrin: Senior Director Government Affairs, Strategy & Geopolitics (Siemens AG | Kiel Institute for the World Economy)

Flach, Lisandra: Director and Professor (ifo Center for International Economics and LMU Munich)

25.08.2026 09:30 - 25.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Classroom 5

A New Intergenerational Contract: Whose Future Is It Anyway?

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Our systems are failing future generations, by design, not accident. This seminar confronts uncomfortable truths about power, privilege, and short-termism, asking what it means to act with intergenerational justice in mind. Rooted in scholarship on provoking consciousness and action, the seminar challenges assumptions that keep unjust systems in place. You will leave with a concrete plan to advance justice where you have the greatest influence.

Sallah, Momodou: Executive Director (National Research and Innovation Fund (The Gambia))

Howe, Sophie: Director (Sophie Howe Associates)

25.08.2026 09:30 - 25.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Embodied Experiences of Democracy

Track: Studio

In this studio, participants explore the political dramaturgy of emotions – where theatre meets sociology. Emotions are movements, words, and gestures that shape how we live together. The ways we stand, speak, and relate enact democratic order. Conversely, emotions we suppress in public to sustain control can quietly erode democracy itself.

//INFO: This project has received funding from the European Commission under the HORIZON Research and Innovation Actions Grant, No 101132327.

Schäfer, Sarah Helena: Political Sociologist (University of Vienna)

Honzírek, Jiri: Screenwriter, dramaturg and director of the Feste Theatre (Feste Theatre / Divadlo Feste)

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One Health Studio: Sensing Future Potential and Identifying New Questions

Track: Studio

Global (One) Health demands more than incremental fixes. This studio shifts from reactive problem-solving to future-oriented innovation. Using sensing and reframing techniques, participants explore emerging potentials and questions in One Health. We challenge existing paradigms to co-create radical new questions and innovation pathways, equipping participants to proactively shape a resilient future.

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Selberherr, Evelyne: Tenured Associate Professor of Microbiome Research (University of Veterinary Medicine Vienna)

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Envisioning Europe's Future Cities

Track: Studio

How can Europe's cities become the places where transition is governed and the future is built? Europe has entered a new phase: climate collapse is no longer a distant risk, but a reality to be governed. This studio builds systems literacy, cross-disciplinary collaboration, and democratic imagination among young professionals. Participants leave with a deeper understanding to act as bridge-builders across sectors, borders, and generations.

//INFO: Clothing and shoes for outdoor activities are recommended.

Elangovan, Emiline: Doctoral Student (Chalmers University of Technology)

Lecker, Fabian: Architect and Researcher (EFFEKT Architects)

25.08.2026 09:30 - 25.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 2

Is Victory Possible in the 21st Century?

Track: Security, Seminar

What does it mean to win? At what costs may victory be achieved? Are the antagonistic and violent practices and narratives of war and victory reconcilable with a sustainable peace? This seminar critically explores the concept of victory from Antiquity to today and specifically looks at the idea of victory in war. By incorporating moral, political, and cultural considerations, victory in the 21st century is reimagined.

Libiseller, Chiara: Lecturer in Strategic Studies (King's College London)

Bojanic, Petar: Professor of Philosophy (University of Belgrade and RECAS)

25.08.2026 09:30 - 25.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Handarbeitsraum

Digital Sovereignty: Why Europe Needs It and How It Can Get It

Track: Democracy, Seminar

If digital sovereignty is about the ability to say ‘yes’ to a digital future that aligns with one’s interests and values – and ‘no’ to a future that doesn’t – Europe currently lacks it. In this workshop, we examine why this is the case and why it matters, what can and what should be done about it, and which policies and politics can get Europe there.

Seidl, Timo: Assistant Professor of Political Economy (Technical University of Munich)

Warso, Zuzanna: Director of Research (Open Future Foundation)

25.08.2026 09:30 - 25.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Feuerwehrhaus - Veranstaltungssaal

Hope and the Power to Shape our Future

Track: Seminar

How do we find the will to act when things seem hopeless? Because we are agents who care, our relationship to the future is driven by emotions like hope, anxiety, and despair – not mere feelings, but evaluative states that orient us toward action. Drawing on philosophy and the science of emotion, this interactive seminar invites you to explore how to harness these emotions, individually and collectively, to bring about the futures you value.

Vazard, Juliette: Senior Researcher (University of Zurich)

Martinez, Camilo: Postdoctoral Researcher (Central European University)

25.08.2026 09:30 - 25.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 1

Science and Ethics

Track: Seminar

Can we separate science and ethics? Where do we draw the boundaries?? In Artificial Intelligence, fairness and accountability are inseparable from how systems learn and how they justify knowledge. Scientific choices are moral choices, and ethics depend on scientific assumptions. The seminar explores good scientific practice and scientific misconduct, including falsification and fraud in academic research.

Mitterer, Josef: Professor (University Klagenfurt)

Neges, Katharina: Senior Scientist (Graz University of Technology)

25.08.2026 09:30 - 25.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 3

Rethinking AI in Context: Health, Environmental Change and Sustainable Futures

Track: Climate, Seminar

AI is reshaping health systems, environments, and societies, bringing opportunities and risks – but who decides how? Who benefits and who gets left behind? How do we plan for the sustainable use of AI? This interactive seminar equips participants to navigate the key debates around AI governance. Discussing foundational concepts, real-world risks, and governance frameworks, we build towards a shared vision of sustainable, equitable AI futures.

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Staunton, Ciara: Experienced Legal and Compliance Expert (BBMRI ERIC)

Amanta, Felippa: PhD candidate and policy researcher (Environmental Change Institute, University of Oxford)

25.08.2026 09:30 - 25.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – EDV Room

Carbon Dioxide Removal from the Atmosphere: A Legal Perspective Beyond Net Zero

Track: Climate, Seminar

The world is on track to exceed 1.5 °C of warming. Climate stabilisation depends on both rapidly cutting emissions and removing carbon dioxide from the atmosphere at scale. Removals are therefore an essential climate action, yet often poorly understood. This seminar explores what carbon dioxide removal is and examines the legal challenges and opportunities of net-negative emissions in the EU and beyond.

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Johnstone, Injy: Senior Research Fellow / Associate (Max Planck Institute for Innovation and Competition / Oxford Net Zero)

Köppen, Martje: DPhil Researcher (University of Oxford)

25.08.2026 09:30 - 25.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Gym

Europe Breaks Free: Reconfiguring Dependencies

Track: Security, Seminar

New forms of great power competition are reshaping the dependency calculus of every region. How can the EU and its global partners reconfigure such dependencies in a world shaped by US-China rivalry, Russian aggression, and the transactional dismantling of multilateralism?

The seminar will tackle this question conceptually but also strategically, asking which dependencies to shed and which to deepen, and explore how to pursue genuine interdependence rather than the illusion of full independence.

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Alemanno, Alberto: Jean Monnet Professor of European Law (HEC Paris / The Good Lobby)

25.08.2026 09:30 - 25.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Physikraum

Financial Technology, Geopolitics, and Digital Sovereignty

Track: Finance, Seminar

Financial technologies are reshaping how markets work and citizens access services – while redrawing the balance between public and private power, transforming how money is created, and opening new arenas of competition among states and between states and corporations. How can we ensure sovereignty, data control, and self-determination in this new world? Designed for non-experts, this seminar unpacks what is at stake for society and the world economy.

Bilotta, Nicola: Senior Research Associate and Coordinator EU-Supervisory Digital Finance Academy / Economist Fellow (Florence School of Banking and Finance - European University Institute / GLOBSEC)

Georg, Co-Pierre: Professor of Practice in Financial Technology (Frankfurt School of Finance & Management)

25.08.2026 13:00 - 25.08.2026 14:30 | Open Network | Wiedersbergerhornbahn - Bergstation

Strangers in a Gondola

Hosted by: Forum Alpbach Network Committee

You are warmly invited to take a delightful 20-minute journey on a gondola up to the majestic Alpbach's mountain. Here's the twist: You will be sharing the gondola with fellow participants who you haven't crossed paths with before. To add an element of fun during your gondola trip, an engaging quiz awaits you, challenging your knowledge without relying on Google, and incorporating time-based questions. Upon reaching the mountain's summit, you can enjoy a delightful coffee and lunch break with the scenic panorama in the restaurant or opt for a refreshing hike. This view is absolutely worth experiencing!

//INFO: Bring hiking shoes or comfortable shoes, water, and sun protection. Remember, you will be in the nature! Please note that you need to bring your Alpbach Card to use the Gondola.

25.08.2026 13:30 - 25.08.2026 14:30 | Chat | Mittelschule – Gym

Food for Thought

Track:

“Food for Thought” takes the form of an open space following the concept of a “Speaker’s Corner”, where anyone is invited to suggest a topic of their choice and facilitate a discussion on it. Anyone – chairs, distinguished visitors, scholarship holders, villagers, EFA staff and others – can host a presentation. We look forward to lively discussions!

//INFO: Please inform the responsible EFA team member the day before you’re planning to speak.

25.08.2026 15:00 - 25.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | CCA – Rogger-Saal

Examining EU Security: Shaping Europe’s Next Security Strategy

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Work Like a Policy Entrepreneur: Turn Moral Ambition into Large Societal Change

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Most people who want to change the world start from a cause they love and a set solution in mind. Policy entrepreneurs ask first: which problem actually needs me and how can I make the most impact? Over five days you learn cause selection, counterfactual thinking, and coalition building, using real cases. You leave with your own theory of change and first steps to make the most impact possible.

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van Putten, Jan-Willem: Executive Director (The School for Moral Ambition)

25.08.2026 15:00 - 25.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 1

Rewilding Environmental Practices

Track: Art, Seminar

What if the future could be otherwise? This seminar explores imaginative agency through lateral thinking: taking detours, embracing surprise, and making the familiar strange. We will read and discuss texts, walk through the forest, observe, photograph, draw, write, cut, paste, and map. Together, we will create a collective utopian map of futures that do not yet exist - but perhaps could.

Ulrich, Antonia: PhD Student, Philosophy (University of Potsdam in coop. with University of Applied Arts Hannover, Design and Media)

Gleim, Meike: Artistic Coordinator and Senior Researcher (Science of Singularities ASBL / Technical University Dortmund)

25.08.2026 15:00 - 25.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | CCA – Loggia

OPCON: An Outdoor-based Leadership Seminar

Track: Seminar

Leading people is the ultimate core competence of the military. The action-oriented outdoor peer-to-peer seminar, led by cadets from the Theresian Military Academy Austria, seeks to find answers to the general theme of EFA26, “How Europe wins”, under the seminar title “OPCON”. In this context, OPCON stands for operational control and is intended to express that a common approach will be needed – while still respecting the sovereignty of the individual actors.

//INFO: The seminar takes place outdoors in all weather conditions. Sportswear and sneakers are recommended.

Gstrein, Alexander: Advisor (Federal Ministry Republic of Austria Defence)

Schiller, Alexander: Staff Officer for Psychological Operations (PsyOps) / Instructor for Communication Trainers (Operations Command Division of the Austrian Armed Forces)

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Elangovan, Emiline: Doctoral Student (Chalmers University of Technology)

Lecker, Fabian: Architect and Researcher (EFFEKT Architects)

25.08.2026 15:00 - 25.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Classroom 5

Dialogue across Divides: Designing Better Conversations for a Polarised World

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Globally, polarisation is rising, yet confrontation isn't inevitable. Constructive dialogue, curiosity over conflict, and finding common ground are choices we can make. This seminar explores the state of division and what it means for society. Through case studies, workshops, and interactive activities, we'll examine the forces shaping political disagreement, and how we can bridge divides to have more productive political conversations.

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McQuone, Rhiannon: Research Associate (More in Common)

MacDonald-Nelson, James: Cities Programme Lead (DemocracyNext)

25.08.2026 15:00 - 25.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Physikraum

Creative Writing: Co-operation, Leadership and Empathy

Track: Art, Seminar

Europe is often treated as geographical entity rather than a community shaped by shared values, such as cooperation, leadership, and empathy. This seminar uses story, poetry, memoir, reflective essays, and collaborative projects to explore ideas of solidarity, responsibility, and belonging across cultures and generations. Participants develop original texts and new perspectives that support dialogue and understanding across borders.

Jeffries, Lauren: Student (Bath Spa University)

Francis, Daphne: Student (Bath Spa University)

English, Lucy: Professor of Creative Enterprise and The Spoken Word (Bath Spa University)

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Honzírek, Jiri: Screenwriter, dramaturg and director of the Feste Theatre (Feste Theatre / Divadlo Feste)

25.08.2026 15:00 - 25.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 3

Theatre as a Sanctuary: How Theatre Builds Confidence and Connection

Track: Art, Seminar

Many actors are introduced to theatre when their parents send them to theatre workshops to overcome their shyness and gain confidence; they end up going on stage in front of hundreds of people. The stage is their place of safety. So, what is it about working together to create a piece of theatre that produces this feeling? This seminar, led by students from the Royal Academy of Dramatic Art in London, will explore this question.

Schiller, Ingrid: Associate Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

Shavit, Yael: Senior Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

25.08.2026 15:00 - 25.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 4

Stronger Together: The Power of the Ensemble.

Track: Art, Seminar

This seminar will explore the ways in which many individuals can end up working as a cohesive team. Creating an effective and dynamic piece of theatre requires every actor to work seamlessly with the rest of the ensemble regardless of whether their part is major or minor. Acting students from the Royal Academy of Dramatic Art in London will share those parts of their training that enable this important connection.

Schiller, Ingrid: Associate Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

Shavit, Yael: Senior Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

25.08.2026 15:00 - 25.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Gym

How Europe Winds

Track: Art, Seminar

Air is essential yet often taken for granted, despite shaping movement, interaction, and perception. The posed question is not How Europe Wins but Winds — like a wind that opens spaces, brings together different voices, and creates new possibilities. Through movement, sound, and collective improvisation, participants are invited to explore ways of expressing themselves artistically. The session culminates in a shared performance, weaving together movement, sound, and expression.

Madlener, Pia: Student (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

Dorfmeister-Pölzer, Hans-Adrian: Master's Student (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

Rademacher, Wiebke: University professor of Music/Arts Education/Head of MA programme (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

25.08.2026 15:00 - 25.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – EDV Room

Activist Filmmaking: Telling Stories of Resistance and Hope

Track: Art, Seminar

Ecological and social crises dominate the newsfeeds, pushing many people into apathy. How can artistic practices offer a way out? In the seminar, stories of resistance will be explored: Participants will learn about activist filmmaking, engage in dialogue about the narratives we are surrounded by, and create their own piece of hope to empower themselves and others.

Geier, Gerald: Designer, filmmaker, strategist (Open Future Lab, Global Shapers Vienna)

Lee, Iara: Activist, Filmmaker, and Cultural Producer (Cultures of Resistance)

25.08.2026 15:00 - 25.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Feuerwehrhaus - Veranstaltungssaal

Capital in Motion: Understanding How Capital Moves the World

Track: Finance, Seminar

This seminar makes capital markets tangible. Participants act as investors, make decisions under uncertainty, and explore how capital shapes companies and Europe's future. Simulation, expert insights, and discussion connect theory with real-world application.

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Lehner, Heike: Economist (independent)

Bayer, Daniel: Founder & Consultant (Fingu GmbH)

25.08.2026 18:15 - 25.08.2026 22:00 | Closed Network | CCA – Otto Molden Foyer

Speed Friending

Hosted by: Forum Alpbach Network Committee

Welcome to Alpbach: This is your chance to meet new people and make lifelong friends! This event offers the perfect opportunity to engage in a series of short, exciting conversations. Each round lasts just a few minutes, giving you the chance to make a memorable first impression and discover common interests.

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26.08.2026 09:00 - 30.08.2026 17:30 | Lab |

Labs: Multi-Day Working Sessions

Track: Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security, Lab

Labs are 3-day facilitated working sessions with a closed and well-selected group of 30 participants that has a joint purpose with the goal that this group, first, becomes a community of action, and second, finds answers to a larger, cross-cutting problem.

Discover the [EFA26 Labs](#).

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Johnstone, Injy: Senior Research Fellow / Associate (Max Planck Institute for Innovation and Competition / Oxford Net Zero)

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Kamin, Katrin: Senior Director Government Affairs, Strategy & Geopolitics (Siemens AG | Kiel Institute for the World Economy)

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A New Intergenerational Contract: Whose Future Is It Anyway?

Track: Democracy, Seminar

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Is Victory Possible in the 21st Century?

Track: Security, Seminar

What does it mean to win? At what costs may victory be achieved? Are the antagonistic and violent practices and narratives of war and victory reconcilable with a sustainable peace? This seminar critically explores the concept of victory from Antiquity to today and specifically looks at the idea of victory in war. By incorporating moral, political, and cultural considerations, victory in the 21st century is reimagined.

Bojanic, Petar: Professor of Philosophy (University of Belgrade and RECAS)

Libiseller, Chiara: Lecturer in Strategic Studies (King's College London)

26.08.2026 09:30 - 26.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Feuerwehrhaus - Veranstaltungssaal

Hope and the Power to Shape our Future

Track: Seminar

How do we find the will to act when things seem hopeless? Because we are agents who care, our relationship to the future is driven by emotions like hope, anxiety, and despair – not mere feelings, but evaluative states that orient us toward action. Drawing on philosophy and the science of emotion, this interactive seminar invites you to explore how to harness these emotions, individually and collectively, to bring about the futures you value.

Vazard, Juliette: Senior Researcher (University of Zurich)

Martinez, Camilo: Postdoctoral Researcher (Central European University)

26.08.2026 09:30 - 26.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | CCA – Heiss-Saal

Envisioning Europe's Future Cities

Track: Studio

How can Europe's cities become the places where transition is governed and the future is built? Europe has entered a new phase: climate collapse is no longer a distant risk, but a reality to be governed. This studio builds systems literacy, cross-disciplinary collaboration, and democratic imagination among young professionals. Participants leave with a deeper understanding to act as bridge-builders across sectors, borders, and generations.

//INFO: Clothing and shoes for outdoor activities are recommended.

Elangovan, Emiline: Doctoral Student (Chalmers University of Technology)

Lecker, Fabian: Architect and Researcher (EFFEKT Architects)

26.08.2026 09:30 - 26.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Handarbeitsraum

Digital Sovereignty: Why Europe Needs It and How It Can Get It

Track: Democracy, Seminar

If digital sovereignty is about the ability to say ‘yes’ to a digital future that aligns with one’s interests and values – and ‘no’ to a future that doesn’t – Europe currently lacks it. In this workshop, we examine why this is the case and why it matters, what can and what should be done about it, and which policies and politics can get Europe there.

Warso, Zuzanna: Director of Research (Open Future Foundation)

Seidl, Timo: Assistant Professor of Political Economy (Technical University of Munich)

26.08.2026 09:30 - 26.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Embodied Experiences of Democracy

Track: Studio

In this studio, participants explore the political dramaturgy of emotions – where theatre meets sociology. Emotions are movements, words, and gestures that shape how we live together. The ways we stand, speak, and relate enact democratic order. Conversely, emotions we suppress in public to sustain control can quietly erode democracy itself.

//INFO: This project has received funding from the European Commission under the HORIZON Research and Innovation Actions Grant, No 101132327.

Honzírek, Jiri: Screenwriter, dramaturg and director of the Feste Theatre (Feste Theatre / Divadlo Feste)

Schäfer, Sarah Helena: Political Sociologist (University of Vienna)

26.08.2026 09:30 - 26.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 1

Science and Ethics

Track: Seminar

Can we separate science and ethics? Where do we draw the boundaries?? In Artificial Intelligence, fairness and accountability are inseparable from how systems learn and how they justify knowledge. Scientific choices are moral choices, and ethics depend on scientific assumptions. The seminar explores good scientific practice and scientific misconduct, including falsification and fraud in academic research.

Neges, Katharina: Senior Scientist (Graz University of Technology)

Mitterer, Josef: Professor (University Klagenfurt)

26.08.2026 09:30 - 26.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | CCA – Flora-Saal

One Health Studio: Sensing Future Potential and Identifying New Questions

Track: Studio

Global (One) Health demands more than incremental fixes. This studio shifts from reactive problem-solving to future-oriented innovation. Using sensing and reframing techniques, participants explore emerging potentials and questions in One Health. We challenge existing paradigms to co-create radical new questions and innovation pathways, equipping participants to proactively shape a resilient future.

//INFO: Please make sure to bring your own laptop. If you do not have one, please contact the EFA-Team at seminars@alpbach.org

Selberherr, Evelyne: Tenured Associate Professor of Microbiome Research (University of Veterinary Medicine Vienna)

Peschl, Markus: Professor of cognitive science and innovation (University of Vienna & theLivingCore)

26.08.2026 13:30 - 26.08.2026 14:30 | Chat | Mittelschule – Gym

Food for Thought

Track:

“Food for Thought” takes the form of an open space following the concept of a “Speaker’s Corner”, where anyone is invited to suggest a topic of their choice and facilitate a discussion on it. Anyone – seminar chairs, distinguished visitors, scholarship holders, villagers, EFA staff and others – can host a presentation. We look forward to lively discussions!

//INFO: Please inform the responsible EFA team member the day before you’re planning to speak.

26.08.2026 15:00 - 26.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Classroom 5

Dialogue across Divides: Designing Better Conversations for a Polarised World

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Globally, polarisation is rising, yet confrontation isn’t inevitable. Constructive dialogue, curiosity over conflict, and finding common ground are choices we can make. This seminar explores the state of division and what it means for society. Through case studies, workshops, and interactive activities, we’ll examine the forces shaping political disagreement, and how we can bridge divides to have more productive political conversations.

//INFO: Please make sure to bring your own laptop. If you do not have one, please contact the EFA-Team at seminars@alpbach.org

MacDonald-Nelson, James: Cities Programme Lead (DemocracyNext)

McQuone, Rhiannon: Research Associate (More in Common)

26.08.2026 15:00 - 26.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | CCA – Flora-Saal

One Health Studio: Sensing Future Potential and Identifying New Questions

Track: Studio

Global (One) Health demands more than incremental fixes. This studio shifts from reactive problem-solving to future-oriented innovation. Using sensing and reframing techniques, participants explore emerging potentials and questions in One Health. We challenge existing paradigms to co-create radical new questions and innovation pathways, equipping participants to proactively shape a resilient future.

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Peschl, Markus: Professor of cognitive science and innovation (University of Vienna & theLivingCore)

Selberherr, Evelyn: Tenured Associate Professor of Microbiome Research (University of Veterinary Medicine Vienna)

26.08.2026 15:00 - 26.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Embodied Experiences of Democracy

Track: Studio

In this studio, participants explore the political dramaturgy of emotions – where theatre meets sociology. Emotions are movements, words, and gestures that shape how we live together. The ways we stand, speak, and relate enact democratic order. Conversely, emotions we suppress in public to sustain control can quietly erode democracy itself.

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Honzírek, Jiri: Screenwriter, dramaturg and director of the Feste Theatre (Feste Theatre / Divadlo Feste)

Schäfer, Sarah Helena: Political Sociologist (University of Vienna)

26.08.2026 15:00 - 26.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Physikraum

Creative Writing: Co-operation, Leadership and Empathy

Track: Art, Seminar

Europe is often treated as geographical entity rather than a community shaped by shared values, such as cooperation, leadership, and empathy. This seminar uses story, poetry, memoir, reflective essays, and collaborative projects to explore ideas of solidarity, responsibility, and belonging across cultures and generations. Participants develop original texts and new perspectives that support dialogue and understanding across borders.

Jeffries, Lauren: Student (Bath Spa University)

Francis, Daphne: Student (Bath Spa University)

English, Lucy: Professor of Creative Enterprise and The Spoken Word (Bath Spa University)

26.08.2026 15:00 - 26.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | CCA – Heiss-Saal

Envisioning Europe's Future Cities

Track: Studio

How can Europe's cities become the places where transition is governed and the future is built? Europe has entered a new phase: climate collapse is no longer a distant risk, but a reality to be governed. This studio builds systems literacy, cross-disciplinary collaboration, and democratic imagination among young professionals. Participants leave with a deeper understanding to act as bridge-builders across sectors, borders, and generations.

Lecker, Fabian: Architect and Researcher (EFFEKT Architects)

Elangovan, Emiline: Doctoral Student (Chalmers University of Technology)

26.08.2026 15:00 - 26.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | CCA – Rogger-Saal

Examining EU Security: Shaping Europe's Next Security Strategy

Track: Studio

Europe's security landscape is changing rapidly, existing strategies no longer reflect today's geopolitical realities. In this Studio, participants will analyse what is needed for Europe to remain relevant, develop their priorities as future leaders as an input for a renewed EU Security Strategy in formulating concrete policy proposals. If you are ready to think outside the box, you have found your event.

Reiterer, Michael: Professor (Centre for Security, Diplomacy and Strategy, Brussels School of Governance, VUB)

Broomé, Ludvig: Analyst at the Europe Programme (The Swedish Institute of International Affairs)

26.08.2026 15:00 - 26.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Handarbeitsraum

Work Like a Policy Entrepreneur: Turn Moral Ambition into Large Societal Change

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Most people who want to change the world start from a cause they love and a set solution in mind. Policy entrepreneurs ask first: which problem actually needs me and how can I make the most impact? Over five days you learn cause selection, counterfactual thinking, and coalition building, using real cases. You leave with your own theory of change and first steps to make the most impact possible.

//INFO: Please make sure to bring your own laptop. If you do not have one, please contact the EFA-Team at seminars@alpbach.org

Bos, Barend: Head of Democracy Program (The School for Moral Ambition)

van Putten, Jan-Willem: Executive Director (The School for Moral Ambition)

26.08.2026 15:00 - 26.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 1

Rewilding Environmental Practices

Track: Art, Seminar

What if the future could be otherwise? This seminar explores imaginative agency through lateral thinking: taking detours, embracing surprise, and making the familiar strange. We will read and discuss texts, walk through the forest, observe, photograph, draw, write, cut, paste, and map. Together, we will create a collective utopian map of futures that do not yet exist - but perhaps could.

Gleim, Meike: Artistic Coordinator and Senior Researcher (Science of Singularities ASBL / Technical University Dortmund)

Ulrich, Antonia: PhD Student, Philosophy (University of Potsdam in coop. with University of Applied Arts Hannover, Design and Media)

26.08.2026 15:00 - 28.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Forecourt

OPCON: An Outdoor-based Leadership Seminar

Track: Seminar

Leading people is the ultimate core competence of the military. The action-oriented outdoor peer-to-peer seminar, led by cadets from the Theresian Military Academy Austria, seeks to find answers to the general theme of EFA26, “How Europe wins”, under the seminar title “OPCON”. In this context, OPCON stands for operational control and is intended to express that a common approach will be needed – while still respecting the sovereignty of the individual actors.

//INFO: The seminar takes place outdoors in all weather conditions. Sportswear and sneakers are recommended.

Gstrein, Alexander: Advisor (Federal Ministry Republic of Austria Defence)

Schiller, Alexander: Staff Officer for Psychological Operations (PsyOps) / Instructor for Communication Trainers (Operations Command Division of the Austrian Armed Forces)

26.08.2026 15:00 - 26.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Feuerwehrhaus - Veranstaltungssaal

Capital in Motion: Understanding How Capital Moves the World

Track: Finance, Seminar

This seminar makes capital markets tangible. Participants act as investors, make decisions under uncertainty, and explore how capital shapes companies and Europe’s future. Simulation, expert insights, and discussion connect theory with real-world application.

//INFO: Please make sure to bring your own laptop. If you do not have one, please contact the EFA-Team at seminars@alpbach.org

Lehner, Heike: Economist (independent)

Bayer, Daniel: Founder & Consultant (Fingu GmbH)

26.08.2026 15:00 - 26.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 4

Stronger Together: The Power of the Ensemble.

Track: Art, Seminar

This seminar will explore the ways in which many individuals can end up working as a cohesive team. Creating an effective and dynamic piece of theatre requires every actor to work seamlessly with the rest of the ensemble regardless of whether their part is major or minor. Acting students from the Royal Academy of Dramatic Art in London will share those parts of their training that enable this important connection.

Shavit, Yael: Senior Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

Schiller, Ingrid: Associate Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

26.08.2026 15:00 - 26.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 3

Theatre as a Sanctuary: How Theatre Builds Confidence and Connection

Track: Art, Seminar

Many actors are introduced to theatre when their parents send them to theatre workshops to overcome their shyness and gain confidence; they end up going on stage in front of hundreds of people. The stage is their place of safety. So, what is it about working together to create a piece of theatre that produces this feeling? This seminar, led by students from the Royal Academy of Dramatic Art in London, will explore this question.

Schiller, Ingrid: Associate Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

Shavit, Yael: Senior Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

26.08.2026 15:00 - 26.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – EDV Room

Activist Filmmaking: Telling Stories of Resistance and Hope

Track: Art, Seminar

Ecological and social crises dominate the newsfeeds, pushing many people into apathy. How can artistic practices offer a way out? In the seminar, stories of resistance will be explored: Participants will learn about activist filmmaking, engage in dialogue about the narratives we are surrounded by, and create their own piece of hope to empower themselves and others.

Lee, Iara: Activist, Filmmaker, and Cultural Producer (Cultures of Resistance)

Geier, Gerald: Designer, filmmaker, strategist (Open Future Lab, Global Shapers Vienna)

26.08.2026 15:00 - 26.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Gym

How Europe Winds

Track: Art, Seminar

Air is essential yet often taken for granted, despite shaping movement, interaction, and perception. The posed question is not How Europe Wins but Winds — like a wind that opens spaces, brings together different voices, and creates new possibilities. Through movement, sound, and collective improvisation, participants are invited to explore ways of expressing themselves artistically. The session culminates in a shared performance, weaving together movement, sound, and expression.

Rademacher, Wiebke: University professor of Music/Arts Education/Head of MA programme (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

Madlener, Pia: Student (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

Dorfmeister-Pölzer, Hans-Adrian: Master's Student (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

26.08.2026 19:00 - 26.08.2026 21:00 | Happening | Volksschule – Gym

Sip and Paint

Hosted by: Forum Alpbach Network Committee

Participants paint on canvas while enjoying the sunset.

27.08.2026 08:15 - 27.08.2026 09:00 | Ritual | Mittelschule – Forecourt

Sunrise Bonding

Hosted by: Forum Alpbach Network Committee

Finding a bit of peace and quiet before EFA's vibrant vibes take over.

27.08.2026 09:00 - 27.08.2026 17:30 | Lab |

Labs: Multi-Day Working Sessions

Track: Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security, Lab

Labs are 3-day facilitated working sessions with a closed and well-selected group of 30 participants that has a joint purpose with the goal that this group, first, becomes a community of action, and second, finds answers to a larger, cross-cutting problem.

Discover the [EFA26 Labs](#).

27.08.2026 09:30 - 27.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | CCA – Rogger-Saal

Examining EU Security: Shaping Europe's Next Security Strategy

Track: Studio

Europe's security landscape is changing rapidly, existing strategies no longer reflect today's geopolitical realities. In this Studio, participants will analyse what is needed for Europe to remain relevant, develop their priorities as future leaders as an input for a renewed EU Security Strategy in formulating concrete policy proposals. If you are ready to think outside the box, you have found your event.

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Reiterer, Michael: Professor (Centre for Security, Diplomacy and Strategy, Brussels School of Governance, VUB)

27.08.2026 09:30 - 27.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | CCA – Heiss-Saal

Envisioning Europe's Future Cities

Track: Studio

How can Europe's cities become the places where transition is governed and the future is built? Europe has entered a new phase: climate collapse is no longer a distant risk, but a reality to be governed. This studio builds systems literacy, cross-disciplinary collaboration, and democratic imagination among young professionals. Participants leave with a deeper understanding to act as bridge-builders across sectors, borders, and generations.

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Lecker, Fabian: Architect and Researcher (EFFEKT Architects)

Elangovan, Emiline: Doctoral Student (Chalmers University of Technology)

27.08.2026 09:30 - 27.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Handarbeitsraum

Digital Sovereignty: Why Europe Needs It and How It Can Get It

Track: Democracy, Seminar

If digital sovereignty is about the ability to say 'yes' to a digital future that aligns with one's interests and values – and 'no' to a future that doesn't – Europe currently lacks it. In this workshop, we examine why this is the case and why it matters, what can and what should be done about it, and which policies and politics can get Europe there.

Seidl, Timo: Assistant Professor of Political Economy (Technical University of Munich)

Warso, Zuzanna: Director of Research (Open Future Foundation)

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Track: Studio

In this studio, participants explore the political dramaturgy of emotions – where theatre meets sociology. Emotions are movements, words, and gestures that shape how we live together. The ways we stand, speak, and relate enact democratic order. Conversely, emotions we suppress in public to sustain control can quietly erode democracy itself.

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Schäfer, Sarah Helena: Political Sociologist (University of Vienna)

Honzírek, Jiri: Screenwriter, dramaturg and director of the Feste Theatre (Feste Theatre / Divadlo Feste)

27.08.2026 09:30 - 27.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 1

Science and Ethics

Track: Seminar

Can we separate science and ethics? Where do we draw the boundaries?? In Artificial Intelligence, fairness and accountability are inseparable from how systems learn and how they justify knowledge. Scientific choices are moral choices, and ethics depend on scientific assumptions. The seminar explores good scientific practice and scientific misconduct, including falsification and fraud in academic research.

Mitterer, Josef: Professor (University Klagenfurt)

Neges, Katharina: Senior Scientist (Graz University of Technology)

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Is Victory Possible in the 21st Century?

Track: Security, Seminar

What does it mean to win? At what costs may victory be achieved? Are the antagonistic and violent practices and narratives of war and victory reconcilable with a sustainable peace? This seminar critically explores the concept of victory from Antiquity to today and specifically looks at the idea of victory in war. By incorporating moral, political, and cultural considerations, victory in the 21st century is reimagined.

Libiseller, Chiara: Lecturer in Strategic Studies (King's College London)

Bojanic, Petar: Professor of Philosophy (University of Belgrade and RECAS)

27.08.2026 09:30 - 27.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Classroom 5

A New Intergenerational Contract: Whose Future Is It Anyway?

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Our systems are failing future generations, by design, not accident. This seminar confronts uncomfortable truths about power, privilege, and short-termism, asking what it means to act with intergenerational justice in mind. Rooted in scholarship on provoking consciousness and action, the seminar challenges assumptions that keep unjust systems in place. You will leave with a concrete plan to advance justice where you have the greatest influence.

Howe, Sophie: Director (Sophie Howe Associates)

Sallah, Momodou: Executive Director (National Research and Innovation Fund (The Gambia))

27.08.2026 09:30 - 27.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 4

Geoeconomics and International Trade Policy

Track: Finance, Seminar

The rules-based international order is under pressure: protectionism and the strategic use of economic policy instruments are reshaping global politics and trade. This seminar explores the rise of geo-economics and examines how states use economic tools to pursue political objectives. Participants will discuss the implications for Europe's open and interconnected economy.

Kamin, Katrin: Senior Director Government Affairs, Strategy & Geopolitics (Siemens AG | Kiel Institute for the World Economy)

Flach, Lisandra: Director and Professor (ifo Center for International Economics and LMU Munich)

27.08.2026 09:30 - 27.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Feuerwehrhaus - Veranstaltungssaal

Hope and the Power to Shape our Future

Track: Seminar

How do we find the will to act when things seem hopeless? Because we are agents who care, our relationship to the future is driven by emotions like hope, anxiety, and despair – not mere feelings, but evaluative states that orient us toward action. Drawing on philosophy and the science of emotion, this interactive seminar invites you to explore how to harness these emotions, individually and collectively, to bring about the futures you value.

Martinez, Camilo: Postdoctoral Researcher (Central European University)

Vazard, Juliette: Senior Researcher (University of Zurich)

27.08.2026 09:30 - 27.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | CCA – Flora-Saal

One Health Studio: Sensing Future Potential and Identifying New Questions

Track: Studio

Global (One) Health demands more than incremental fixes. This studio shifts from reactive problem-solving to future-oriented innovation. Using sensing and reframing techniques, participants explore emerging potentials and questions in One Health. We challenge existing paradigms to co-create radical new questions and innovation pathways, equipping participants to proactively shape a resilient future.

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Selberherr, Evelyne: Tenured Associate Professor of Microbiome Research (University of Veterinary Medicine Vienna)

Peschl, Markus: Professor of cognitive science and innovation (University of Vienna & theLivingCore)

27.08.2026 09:30 - 27.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Gym

Europe Breaks Free: Reconfiguring Dependencies

Track: Security, Seminar

New forms of great power competition are reshaping the dependency calculus of every region. How can the EU and its global partners reconfigure such dependencies in a world shaped by US-China rivalry, Russian aggression, and the transactional dismantling of multilateralism?

The seminar will tackle this question conceptually but also strategically, asking which dependencies to shed and which to deepen, and explore how to pursue genuine interdependence rather than the illusion of full independence.

Alemanno, Alberto: Jean Monnet Professor of European Law (HEC Paris / The Good Lobby)

Bialasiewicz, Luiza: Professor of Political and Economic Geography (Ca' Foscari University of Venice)

27.08.2026 09:30 - 27.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Physikraum

Financial Technology, Geopolitics, and Digital Sovereignty

Track: Finance, Seminar

Financial technologies are reshaping how markets work and citizens access services – while redrawing the balance between public and private power, transforming how money is created, and opening new arenas of competition among states and between states and corporations. How can we ensure sovereignty, data control, and self-determination in this new world? Designed for non-experts, this seminar unpacks what is at stake for society and the world economy.

Bilotta, Nicola: Senior Research Associate and Coordinator EU-Supervisory Digital Finance Academy / Economist Fellow (Florence School of Banking and Finance - European University Institute / GLOBSEC)

Georg, Co-Pierre: Professor of Practice in Financial Technology (Frankfurt School of Finance & Management)

27.08.2026 09:30 - 27.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – EDV Room

Carbon Dioxide Removal from the Atmosphere: A Legal Perspective Beyond Net Zero

Track: Climate, Seminar

The world is on track to exceed 1.5 °C of warming. Climate stabilisation depends on both rapidly cutting emissions and removing carbon dioxide from the atmosphere at scale. Removals are therefore an essential climate action, yet often poorly understood. This seminar explores what carbon dioxide removal is and examines the legal challenges and opportunities of net-negative emissions in the EU and beyond.

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Johnstone, Injy: Senior Research Fellow / Associate (Max Planck Institute for Innovation and Competition / Oxford Net Zero)

Köppen, Martje: DPhil Researcher (University of Oxford)

27.08.2026 09:30 - 27.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 3

Rethinking AI in Context: Health, Environmental Change and Sustainable Futures

Track: Climate, Seminar

AI is reshaping health systems, environments, and societies, bringing opportunities and risks – but who decides how? Who benefits and who gets left behind? How do we plan for the sustainable use of AI? This interactive seminar equips participants to navigate the key debates around AI governance. Discussing foundational concepts, real-world risks, and governance frameworks, we build towards a shared vision of sustainable, equitable AI futures.

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Staunton, Ciara: Experienced Legal and Compliance Expert (BBMRI ERIC)

Amanta, Felippa: PhD candidate and policy researcher (Environmental Change Institute, University of Oxford)

27.08.2026 11:00 - 27.08.2026 12:00 | Stage | CCA - Loggia

15 Years of the Euregio Tyrol-South Tyrol-Trentino

Hosted by: Euregio

Track: Democracy

Anniversaries always mark an important moment for reflection and contextualisation. This session highlights the development since its founding, key milestones, and their relevance today for cross-border cooperation. Building on this, perspectives from practice and research will be brought together, and points of departure for the future orientation of the Euregio and other European Groupings of Territorial Cooperation (EGTCs) will be outlined.

Platter, Günther:

Durnwalder, Luis: Governor of the Autonomous Province of Bolzano-South Tyrol from 1989 to 2014

27.08.2026 13:30 - 27.08.2026 14:30 | Chat | Mittelschule - Gym

Food for Thought

Track: Seminar, Studio

"Food for Thought" takes the form of an open space following the concept of a "Speaker's Corner", where anyone is invited to suggest a topic of their choice and facilitate a discussion on it. Anyone – seminar chairs, distinguished visitors, scholarship holders, villagers, EFA staff and others – can host a presentation. We look forward to lively discussions!

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27.08.2026 13:30 - 27.08.2026 14:30 | Chat | CCA - Rogger-Saal

Becoming a Co-Author of the EFA Academy Days Book

In this session, scholarship holders and other participants of the Academy Days are invited to collaborate on a book about the topics and themes of EFA26. They will be guided through writing their stories about the Academy Days, energizing encounters, and other reflections.

Jeffries, Lauren: Student (Bath Spa University)

Francis, Daphne: Student (Bath Spa University)

English, Lucy: Professor of Creative Enterprise and The Spoken Word (Bath Spa University)

27.08.2026 15:00 - 27.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule - Ground Floor - Classroom 1

Rewilding Environmental Practices

Track: Art, Seminar

What if the future could be otherwise? This seminar explores imaginative agency through lateral thinking: taking detours, embracing surprise, and making the familiar strange. We will read and discuss texts, walk through the forest, observe, photograph, draw, write, cut, paste, and map. Together, we will create a collective utopian map of futures that do not yet exist - but perhaps could.

Gleim, Meike: Artistic Coordinator and Senior Researcher (Science of Singularities ASBL / Technical University Dortmund)

Ulrich, Antonia: PhD Student, Philosophy (University of Potsdam in coop. with University of Applied Arts Hannover, Design and Media)

27.08.2026 15:00 - 27.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Your Voice on Wealth: A Citizens' Assembly

Track: Studio

A pioneering Citizens' Assembly brings together young participants to discuss wealth inequality across Europe and beyond. Drawing on high-level expert input and facilitated discussions, participants explore the causes and consequences of extreme wealth concentration and co-create bold, evidence-based solutions for a fairer distribution of wealth, strengthening democracy, social cohesion, and Europe's future.

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Alcazar Cid, Marina: Doctoral Researcher and Co-Founder (Paris School of Economics | Club Alpbach Spain | the Wealth Cap Project)

Trinh, Nhat An: Sociologist (WZB Berlin Social Science Center)

27.08.2026 15:00 - 27.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Feuerwehrhaus – Seminar Room

Perspectives on European Memory: Objects, Stories and Shared Futures

Track: Studio

European memory is shaped by diverse, contradictory perspectives. How can personal memories help connect perspectives and our lives without reducing them to a single story? In this Studio, we will interpret and connect objects/family stories linked to Europe's past to gain new perspectives, link past and present, and co-create narratives that make European memory tangible and relevant for our futures.

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Goslar, Fabian: Founder (Enkel Europas)

Pfister, Jannik: Head of European Identity (Hertie Foundation)

27.08.2026 15:00 - 27.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Volksschule – Backyard – Classroom 1

From Complexity to Capacity: Policy Design under Volatility and Interdependence

Track: Studio

How can public decisions remain accountable when the conditions around them keep shifting? This Studio brings together complexity science, data, models, and concrete EU policy cases. Participants engage with cases from the European Parliament and prototype approaches to test assumptions, uncertainties, and systemic effects before decisions become difficult and costly to revise.

This Studio is organised by nextlearning e. V. and the Complexity Science Hub, in cooperation with the European Parliament.

Sorge, Andreas: Lead Specialist (PD Science Group)

Zsambok, Jakob: Researcher (Complexity Science Hub Vienna)

Kondor, Daniel: Postdoctoral Researcher (Complexity Science Hub)

Reddish, Jenny: Staff Scientist and Lead Editor (Complexity Science Hub & Seshat Global History Databank)

27.08.2026 15:00 - 27.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Handarbeitsraum

Work Like a Policy Entrepreneur: Turn Moral Ambition into Large Societal Change

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Most people who want to change the world start from a cause they love and a set solution in mind. Policy entrepreneurs ask first: which problem actually needs me and how can I make the most impact? Over five days you learn cause selection, counterfactual thinking, and coalition building, using real cases. You leave with your own theory of change and first steps to make the most impact possible.

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Bos, Barend: Head of Democracy Program (The School for Moral Ambition)

van Putten, Jan-Willem: Executive Director (The School for Moral Ambition)

27.08.2026 15:00 - 27.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Forecourt

OPCON: An Outdoor-based Leadership Seminar

Track: Seminar

Leading people is the ultimate core competence of the military. The action-oriented outdoor peer-to-peer seminar, led by cadets from the Theresian Military Academy Austria, seeks to find answers to the general theme of EFA26, “How Europe wins”, under the seminar title “OPCON”. In this context, OPCON stands for operational control and is intended to express that a common approach will be needed – while still respecting the sovereignty of the individual actors.

//INFO: The seminar takes place outdoors in all weather conditions. Sportswear and sneakers are recommended.

Schiller, Alexander: Staff Officer for Psychological Operations (PsyOps) / Instructor for Communication Trainers (Operations Command Division of the Austrian Armed Forces)

Gstrein, Alexander: Advisor (Federal Ministry Republic of Austria Defence)

27.08.2026 15:00 - 27.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 3

Theatre as a Sanctuary: How Theatre Builds Confidence and Connection

Track: Art, Seminar

Many actors are introduced to theatre when their parents send them to theatre workshops to overcome their shyness and gain confidence; they end up going on stage in front of hundreds of people. The stage is their place of safety. So, what is it about working together to create a piece of theatre that produces this feeling? This seminar, led by students from the Royal Academy of Dramatic Art in London, will explore this question.

Schiller, Ingrid: Associate Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

Shavit, Yael: Senior Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

27.08.2026 15:00 - 27.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 4

Stronger Together: The Power of the Ensemble.

Track: Art, Seminar

This seminar will explore the ways in which many individuals can end up working as a cohesive team. Creating an effective and dynamic piece of theatre requires every actor to work seamlessly with the rest of the ensemble regardless of whether their part is major or minor. Acting students from the Royal Academy of Dramatic Art in London will share those parts of their training that enable this important connection.

Schiller, Ingrid: Associate Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

Shavit, Yael: Senior Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

27.08.2026 15:00 - 27.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Feuerwehrhaus - Veranstaltungssaal

Capital in Motion: Understanding How Capital Moves the World

Track: Finance, Seminar

This seminar makes capital markets tangible. Participants act as investors, make decisions under uncertainty, and explore how capital shapes companies and Europe's future. Simulation, expert insights, and discussion connect theory with real-world application.

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Bayer, Daniel: Founder & Consultant (Fingu GmbH)

Lehner, Heike: Economist (independent)

27.08.2026 15:00 - 27.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Classroom 5

Dialogue across Divides: Designing Better Conversations for a Polarised World

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Globally, polarisation is rising, yet confrontation isn't inevitable. Constructive dialogue, curiosity over conflict, and finding common ground are choices we can make. This seminar explores the state of division and what it means for society. Through case studies, workshops, and interactive activities, we'll examine the forces shaping political disagreement, and how we can bridge divides to have more productive political conversations.

//INFO: Please make sure to bring your own laptop. If you do not have one, please contact the EFA-Team at seminars@alpbach.org

McQuone, Rhiannon: Research Associate (More in Common)

MacDonald-Nelson, James: Cities Programme Lead (DemocracyNext)

27.08.2026 15:00 - 27.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Physikraum

Creative Writing: Co-operation, Leadership and Empathy

Track: Art, Seminar

Europe is often treated as geographical entity rather than a community shaped by shared values, such as cooperation, leadership, and empathy. This seminar uses story, poetry, memoir, reflective essays, and collaborative projects to explore ideas of solidarity, responsibility, and belonging across cultures and generations. Participants develop original texts and new perspectives that support dialogue and understanding across borders.

Jeffries, Lauren: Student (Bath Spa University)

Francis, Daphne: Student (Bath Spa University)

English, Lucy: Professor of Creative Enterprise and The Spoken Word (Bath Spa University)

27.08.2026 15:00 - 27.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Gym

How Europe Winds

Track: Art, Seminar

Air is essential yet often taken for granted, despite shaping movement, interaction, and perception. The posed question is not How Europe Wins but Winds — like a wind that opens spaces, brings together different voices, and creates new possibilities. Through movement, sound, and collective improvisation, participants are invited to explore ways of expressing themselves artistically. The session culminates in a shared performance, weaving together movement, sound, and expression.

Madlener, Pia: Student (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

Rademacher, Wiebke: University professor of Music/Arts Education/Head of MA programme (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

Dorfmeister-Pölzer, Hans-Adrian: Master's Student (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

27.08.2026 15:00 - 27.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – EDV Room

Activist Filmmaking: Telling Stories of Resistance and Hope

Track: Art, Seminar

Ecological and social crises dominate the newsfeeds, pushing many people into apathy. How can artistic practices offer a way out? In the seminar, stories of resistance will be explored: Participants will learn about activist filmmaking, engage in dialogue about the narratives we are surrounded by, and create their own piece of hope to empower themselves and others.

Geier, Gerald: Designer, filmmaker, strategist (Open Future Lab, Global Shapers Vienna)

Lee, Iara: Activist, Filmmaker, and Cultural Producer (Cultures of Resistance)

27.08.2026 20:15 - 27.08.2026 22:00 | Stage | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

International Evening

Hosted by: Forum Alpbach Network Committee

The International Evening is a vibrant event showcasing the cultural diversity of the participants from different nationalities. With interactive elements and engaging activities, it creates an immersive experience celebrating global unity and fostering cross-cultural connections.

INFO: Please feel warmly invited to attend the International Evening in your traditional clothing.

The EFA Code of Conduct needs to be respected.

28.08.2026 08:15 - 28.08.2026 09:00 | Ritual | Mittelschule – Forecourt

Sunrise Bonding

Hosted by: Forum Alpbach Network Committee

Finding a bit of peace and quiet before EFA's vibrant vibes take over.

28.08.2026 08:30 - 28.08.2026 10:00 | Open Network | Hotel Alphof – Right Dining Hall

Practice Breakfast

Hosted by: Standortagentur Tirol & Plattform Industrie 4.0

Track: Finance

Industry experts outline what is already possible today and where the journey will lead in the near future. Participants will receive numerous insights into expected developments in the near and medium term. In addition, they will gain an overview of solutions that simplify everyday work and make production processes more efficient.

28.08.2026 09:00 - 28.08.2026 17:30 | Lab |

Labs: Multi-Day Working Sessions

Track: Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security, Lab

Labs are 3-day facilitated working sessions with a closed and well-selected group of 30 participants that has a joint purpose with the goal that this group, first, becomes a community of action, and second, finds answers to a larger, cross-cutting problem.

Discover the [EFA26 Labs](#).

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:00 | Hike | Hike Start 1 | CCA Square

Hike | Euregio Inntal: Mobility. Digitalisation. Future!

Hosted by: Euregio Tirol-Südtirol-Trentino

Track: Climate

Mobility and digitalisation pose new strategic challenges for the Euregio Inntal. This Hike combines expert input with exchange and discussion. The focus of the conversations is on the future perspectives of this area of cooperation and the development of joint strategic approaches across borders. The Hike concludes at the Bischofer Käsalm.

//INFO: Bring sturdy shoes and water.

//INFO: In case of heavy rain, the session is going to take place at CCA – Rogger Hall.

Teschenet, Manuel: Managing director of Kufstein mobil

Schwaighofer, Barbara: President of Euregio Inntal

Jennings, Esther: Managing Director of Euregio Inntal

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Feuerwehrhaus – Seminar Room

Perspectives on European Memory: Objects, Stories and Shared Futures

Track: Studio

European memory is shaped by diverse, contradictory perspectives. How can personal memories help connect perspectives and our lives without reducing them to a single story? In this Studio, we will interpret and connect objects/family stories linked to Europe's past to gain new perspectives, link past and present, and co-create narratives that make European memory tangible and relevant for our futures.

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Pfister, Jannik: Head of European Identity (Hertie Foundation)

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Volksschule – Backyard – Classroom 1

From Complexity to Capacity: Policy Design under Volatility and Interdependence

Track: Studio

How can public decisions remain accountable when the conditions around them keep shifting? This Sstudio brings together complexity science, data, models, and concrete EU policy cases. Participants engage with cases from the European Parliament and prototype approaches to test assumptions, uncertainties, and systemic effects before decisions become difficult and costly to revise.

This Studio is organised by nextlearning e. V. and the Complexity Science Hub, in cooperation with the European Parliament.

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Kondor, Daniel: Postdoctoral Researcher (Complexity Science Hub)

Sorge, Andreas: Lead Specialist (PD Science Group)

Reddish, Jenny: Staff Scientist and Lead Editor (Complexity Science Hub & Seshat Global History Databank)

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Feuerwehrhaus - Veranstaltungssaal

Hope and the Power to Shape our Future

Track: Seminar

How do we find the will to act when things seem hopeless? Because we are agents who care, our relationship to the future is driven by emotions like hope, anxiety, and despair – not mere feelings, but evaluative states that orient us toward action. Drawing on philosophy and the science of emotion, this interactive seminar invites you to explore how to harness these emotions, individually and collectively, to bring about the futures you value.

Martinez, Camilo: Postdoctoral Researcher (Central European University)

Vazard, Juliette: Senior Researcher (University of Zurich)

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Physikraum

Financial Technology, Geopolitics, and Digital Sovereignty

Track: Finance, Seminar

Financial technologies are reshaping how markets work and citizens access services – while redrawing the balance between public and private power, transforming how money is created, and opening new arenas of competition among states and between states and corporations. How can we ensure sovereignty, data control, and self-determination in this new world? Designed for non-experts, this seminar unpacks what is at stake for society and the world economy.

Bilotta, Nicola: Senior Research Associate and Coordinator EU-Supervisory Digital Finance Academy / Economist Fellow (Florence School of Banking and Finance - European University Institute / GLOBSEC)

Georg, Co-Pierre: Professor of Practice in Financial Technology (Frankfurt School of Finance & Management)

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Gym

Europe Breaks Free: Reconfiguring Dependencies

Track: Security, Seminar

New forms of great power competition are reshaping the dependency calculus of every region. How can the EU and its global partners reconfigure such dependencies in a world shaped by US-China rivalry, Russian aggression, and the transactional dismantling of multilateralism?

The seminar will tackle this question conceptually but also strategically, asking which dependencies to shed and which to deepen, and explore how to pursue genuine interdependence rather than the illusion of full independence.

Alemanno, Alberto: Jean Monnet Professor of European Law (HEC Paris / The Good Lobby)

Bialasiewicz, Luiza: Professor of Political and Economic Geography (Ca' Foscari University of Venice)

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Your Voice on Wealth: A Citizens' Assembly

Track: Studio

A pioneering Citizens' Assembly brings together young participants to discuss wealth inequality across Europe and beyond. Drawing on high-level expert input and facilitated discussions, participants explore the causes and consequences of extreme wealth concentration and co-create bold, evidence-based solutions for a fairer distribution of wealth, strengthening democracy, social cohesion, and Europe's future.

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Trinh, Nhat An: Sociologist (WZB Berlin Social Science Center)

Alcazar Cid, Marina: Doctoral Researcher and Co-Founder (Paris School of Economics | Club Alpbach Spain | the Wealth Cap Project)

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 2

Is Victory Possible in the 21st Century?

Track: Security, Seminar

What does it mean to win? At what costs may victory be achieved? Are the antagonistic and violent practices and narratives of war and victory reconcilable with a sustainable peace? This seminar critically explores the concept of victory from Antiquity to today and specifically looks at the idea of victory in war. By incorporating moral, political, and cultural considerations, victory in the 21st century is reimagined.

Libiseller, Chiara: Lecturer in Strategic Studies (King's College London)

Bojanic, Petar: Professor of Philosophy (University of Belgrade and RECAS)

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 1

Science and Ethics

Track: Seminar

Can we separate science and ethics? Where do we draw the boundaries?? In Artificial Intelligence, fairness and accountability are inseparable from how systems learn and how they justify knowledge. Scientific choices are moral choices, and ethics depend on scientific assumptions. The seminar explores good scientific practice and scientific misconduct, including falsification and fraud in academic research.

Mitterer, Josef: Professor (University Klagenfurt)

Neges, Katharina: Senior Scientist (Graz University of Technology)

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Handarbeitsraum

Digital Sovereignty: Why Europe Needs It and How It Can Get It

Track: Democracy, Seminar

If digital sovereignty is about the ability to say ‘yes’ to a digital future that aligns with one’s interests and values – and ‘no’ to a future that doesn’t – Europe currently lacks it. In this workshop, we examine why this is the case and why it matters, what can and what should be done about it, and which policies and politics can get Europe there.

Warso, Zuzanna: Director of Research (Open Future Foundation)

Seidl, Timo: Assistant Professor of Political Economy (Technical University of Munich)

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 4

Geoeconomics and International Trade Policy

Track: Finance, Seminar

The rules-based international order is under pressure: protectionism and the strategic use of economic policy instruments are reshaping global politics and trade. This seminar explores the rise of geo-economics and examines how states use economic tools to pursue political objectives. Participants will discuss the implications for Europe’s open and interconnected economy.

Kamin, Katrin: Senior Director Government Affairs, Strategy & Geopolitics (Siemens AG | Kiel Institute for the World Economy)

Flach, Lisandra: Director and Professor (ifo Center for International Economics and LMU Munich)

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Classroom 5

A New Intergenerational Contract: Whose Future Is It Anyway?

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Our systems are failing future generations, by design, not accident. This seminar confronts uncomfortable truths about power, privilege, and short-termism, asking what it means to act with intergenerational justice in mind. Rooted in scholarship on provoking consciousness and action, the seminar challenges assumptions that keep unjust systems in place. You will leave with a concrete plan to advance justice where you have the greatest influence.

Sallah, Momodou: Executive Director (National Research and Innovation Fund (The Gambia))

Howe, Sophie: Director (Sophie Howe Associates)

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – EDV Room

Carbon Dioxide Removal from the Atmosphere: A Legal Perspective Beyond Net Zero

Track: Climate, Seminar

The world is on track to exceed 1.5 °C of warming. Climate stabilisation depends on both rapidly cutting emissions and removing carbon dioxide from the atmosphere at scale. Removals are therefore an essential climate action, yet often poorly understood. This seminar explores what carbon dioxide removal is and examines the legal challenges and opportunities of net-negative emissions in the EU and beyond.

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Johnstone, Injy: Senior Research Fellow / Associate (Max Planck Institute for Innovation and Competition / Oxford Net Zero)

Köppen, Martje: DPhil Researcher (University of Oxford)

28.08.2026 09:30 - 28.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 3

Rethinking AI in Context: Health, Environmental Change and Sustainable Futures

Track: Climate, Seminar

AI is reshaping health systems, environments, and societies, bringing opportunities and risks – but who decides how? Who benefits and who gets left behind? How do we plan for the sustainable use of AI? This interactive seminar equips participants to navigate the key debates around AI governance. Discussing foundational concepts, real-world risks, and governance frameworks, we build towards a shared vision of sustainable, equitable AI futures.

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Amanta, Felippa: PhD candidate and policy researcher (Environmental Change Institute, University of Oxford)

Staunton, Ciara: Experienced Legal and Compliance Expert (BBMRI ERIC)

28.08.2026 10:30 - 28.08.2026 12:00 | Open Network | Hotel Alphof – Right Dining Hall

Tyrolean Technology Brunch

Hosted by: Standortagentur Tirol & Plattform Industrie 4.0

Track: Finance

An exclusive networking event as part of the Euregio Days 2026: take the opportunity to exchange ideas with representatives from business, academia, politics, and regional development on technology and digitalisation in Tyrol and Europe.

28.08.2026 13:00 - 28.08.2026 14:00 | | CCA – Loggia

Europe Delivers. Young Entrepreneurs on Responsibility and Europe's Future

Hosted by: Junge Industrie und IV Tirol

Track: Finance

National approaches often reach their limits, while key challenges are increasingly cross-border in nature. Approaches to strengthening competitiveness, innovation, skilled workforce, and digitalisation in Europe are discussed. This generates momentum for concrete reform steps and future economic resilience.

Vahrner, Alois:

Fröschl, Eduard jun.: Managing Director (Fröschl AG & Co. KG)

Gruber, Daniela: Managing Director (SilberQuelle GmbH)

Silbernagel, Lukas: Founder (tincx)

Dorner, Kilian: Managing Director (Dorner Electronic GmbH)

28.08.2026 13:30 - 28.08.2026 14:30 | Chat | Mittelschule – Gym

Food for Thought

Track: Seminar, Studio

“Food for Thought” takes the form of an open space following the concept of a “Speaker’s Corner”, where anyone is invited to suggest a topic of their choice and facilitate a discussion on it. Anyone – seminar chairs, distinguished visitors, scholarship holders, villagers, EFA staff and others – can host a presentation. We look forward to lively discussions!

//INFO: Please inform the responsible EFA team member the day before you’re planning to speak.

28.08.2026 15:00 - 28.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Forecourt

OPCON: An Outdoor-based Leadership Seminar

Track: Seminar

Leading people is the ultimate core competence of the military. The action-oriented outdoor peer-to-peer seminar, led by cadets from the Theresian Military Academy Austria, seeks to find answers to the general theme of EFA26, “How Europe wins”, under the seminar title “OPCON”. In this context, OPCON stands for operational control and is intended to express that a common approach will be needed – while still respecting the sovereignty of the individual actors.

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Gstrein, Alexander: Advisor (Federal Ministry Republic of Austria Defence)

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Stronger Together: The Power of the Ensemble.

Track: Art, Seminar

This seminar will explore the ways in which many individuals can end up working as a cohesive team. Creating an effective and dynamic piece of theatre requires every actor to work seamlessly with the rest of the ensemble regardless of whether their part is major or minor. Acting students from the Royal Academy of Dramatic Art in London will share those parts of their training that enable this important connection.

Schiller, Ingrid: Associate Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

Shavit, Yael: Senior Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

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Track: Finance, Seminar

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Bayer, Daniel: Founder & Consultant (Fingu GmbH)

Lehner, Heike: Economist (independent)

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Theatre as a Sanctuary: How Theatre Builds Confidence and Connection

Track: Art, Seminar

Many actors are introduced to theatre when their parents send them to theatre workshops to overcome their shyness and gain confidence; they end up going on stage in front of hundreds of people. The stage is their place of safety. So, what is it about working together to create a piece of theatre that produces this feeling? This seminar, led by students from the Royal Academy of Dramatic Art in London, will explore this question.

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Shavit, Yael: Senior Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

28.08.2026 15:00 - 28.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – EDV Room

Activist Filmmaking: Telling Stories of Resistance and Hope

Track: Art, Seminar

Ecological and social crises dominate the newsfeeds, pushing many people into apathy. How can artistic practices offer a way out? In the seminar, stories of resistance will be explored: Participants will learn about activist filmmaking, engage in dialogue about the narratives we are surrounded by, and create their own piece of hope to empower themselves and others.

Geier, Gerald: Designer, filmmaker, strategist (Open Future Lab, Global Shapers Vienna)

Lee, Iara: Activist, Filmmaker, and Cultural Producer (Cultures of Resistance)

28.08.2026 15:00 - 28.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Gym

How Europe Winds

Track: Art, Seminar

Air is essential yet often taken for granted, despite shaping movement, interaction, and perception. The posed question is not How Europe Wins but Winds — like a wind that opens spaces, brings together different voices, and creates new possibilities. Through movement, sound, and collective improvisation, participants are invited to explore ways of expressing themselves artistically. The session culminates in a shared performance, weaving together movement, sound, and expression.

Rademacher, Wiebke: University professor of Music/Arts Education/Head of MA programme (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

Madlener, Pia: Student (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

Dorfmeister-Pölzer, Hans-Adrian: Master's Student (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

28.08.2026 15:00 - 28.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Volksschule – Backyard – Classroom 1

From Complexity to Capacity: Policy Design under Volatility and Interdependence

Track: Studio

How can public decisions remain accountable when the conditions around them keep shifting? This Studio brings together complexity science, data, models, and concrete EU policy cases. Participants engage with cases from the European Parliament and prototype approaches to test assumptions, uncertainties, and systemic effects before decisions become difficult and costly to revise.

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Reddish, Jenny: Staff Scientist and Lead Editor (Complexity Science Hub & Seshat Global History Databank)

Sorge, Andreas: Lead Specialist (PD Science Group)

Zsambok, Jakob: Researcher (Complexity Science Hub Vienna)

Kondor, Daniel: Postdoctoral Researcher (Complexity Science Hub)

28.08.2026 15:00 - 28.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Handarbeitsraum

Work Like a Policy Entrepreneur: Turn Moral Ambition into Large Societal Change

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Most people who want to change the world start from a cause they love and a set solution in mind. Policy entrepreneurs ask first: which problem actually needs me and how can I make the most impact? Over five days you learn cause selection, counterfactual thinking, and coalition building, using real cases. You leave with your own theory of change and first steps to make the most impact possible.

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Bos, Barend: Head of Democracy Program (The School for Moral Ambition)

van Putten, Jan-Willem: Executive Director (The School for Moral Ambition)

28.08.2026 15:00 - 28.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Feuerwehrhaus – Seminar Room

Perspectives on European Memory: Objects, Stories and Shared Futures

Track: Studio

European memory is shaped by diverse, contradictory perspectives. How can personal memories help connect perspectives and our lives without reducing them to a single story? In this Studio, we will interpret and connect objects/family stories linked to Europe's past to gain new perspectives, link past and present, and co-create narratives that make European memory tangible and relevant for our futures.

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Pfister, Jannik: Head of European Identity (Hertie Foundation)

Goslar, Fabian: Founder (Enkel Europas)

28.08.2026 15:00 - 28.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 1

Rewilding Environmental Practices

Track: Art, Seminar

What if the future could be otherwise? This seminar explores imaginative agency through lateral thinking: taking detours, embracing surprise, and making the familiar strange. We will read and discuss texts, walk through the forest, observe, photograph, draw, write, cut, paste, and map. Together, we will create a collective utopian map of futures that do not yet exist - but perhaps could.

Gleim, Meike: Artistic Coordinator and Senior Researcher (Science of Singularities ASBL / Technical University Dortmund)

Ulrich, Antonia: PhD Student, Philosophy (University of Potsdam in coop. with University of Applied Arts Hannover, Design and Media)

28.08.2026 15:00 - 28.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Your Voice on Wealth: A Citizens' Assembly

Track: Studio

A pioneering Citizens' Assembly brings together young participants to discuss wealth inequality across Europe and beyond. Drawing on high-level expert input and facilitated discussions, participants explore the causes and consequences of extreme wealth concentration and co-create bold, evidence-based solutions for a fairer distribution of wealth, strengthening democracy, social cohesion, and Europe's future.

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Alcazar Cid, Marina: Doctoral Researcher and Co-Founder (Paris School of Economics | Club Alpbach Spain | the Wealth Cap Project)

Trinh, Nhat An: Sociologist (WZB Berlin Social Science Center)

28.08.2026 15:00 - 28.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Classroom 5

Dialogue across Divides: Designing Better Conversations for a Polarised World

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Globally, polarisation is rising, yet confrontation isn't inevitable. Constructive dialogue, curiosity over conflict, and finding common ground are choices we can make. This seminar explores the state of division and what it means for society. Through case studies, workshops, and interactive activities, we'll examine the forces shaping political disagreement, and how we can bridge divides to have more productive political conversations.

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McQuone, Rhiannon: Research Associate (More in Common)

MacDonald-Nelson, James: Cities Programme Lead (DemocracyNext)

28.08.2026 15:00 - 28.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Physikraum

Creative Writing: Co-operation, Leadership and Empathy

Track: Art, Seminar

Europe is often treated as geographical entity rather than a community shaped by shared values, such as cooperation, leadership, and empathy. This seminar uses story, poetry, memoir, reflective essays, and collaborative projects to explore ideas of solidarity, responsibility, and belonging across cultures and generations. Participants develop original texts and new perspectives that support dialogue and understanding across borders.

Jeffries, Lauren: Student (Bath Spa University)

Francis, Daphne: Student (Bath Spa University)

English, Lucy: Professor of Creative Enterprise and The Spoken Word (Bath Spa University)

28.08.2026 18:30 - 28.08.2026 20:00 | Open Network | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

Career Development: Future Skills in the Euregio Labour Market

Hosted by: Euregio Tirol-Südtirol-Trentino and its European University Alliances

Track: Finance

The labour market in the Euregio Tyrol-South Tyrol-Trentino is changing rapidly due to new skill demands. This session brings together perspectives from higher education, vocational education and practice to discuss Future Skills in an open dialogue. The exchange highlights regional qualification needs and outlines pathways for cross-border career development.

Stoitzner, Patrizia: Exec. Vice President for Research and International Relations, Medical University of Innsbruck

Deflorian, Flavio: Rector, University of Trento

Baratieri, Marco: Vice Rector for Studies, Free University of Bozen-Bolzano

Försterling, Hannah: Session Chair, Extended Board, Club Alpbach Tirol

Mirski, Peter: Chief Information Officer, MCI | The Entrepreneurial School

28.08.2026 19:00 - 28.08.2026 19:30 | Ritual | Church

Into the Silence

A place of calm: Spiritual impulses from various religious and philosophical backgrounds invite you to contemplate and reflect. Inspiring initiators tell their stories, take you on a journey of the mind and initiate moments of genuine stillness.

Axmann, Philipp: Youth Worker (Protestant Church of Austria)

28.08.2026 20:00 - 28.08.2026 20:30 | Ritual | Village Square

Open Air Concert: Alpbach Brass Band

On Fridays during the summer months, the Alpbach brass band gives an open-air concert in the village square. All Alpbach residents as well as national and international guests are warmly invited!

28.08.2026 20:30 - 28.08.2026 23:00 | Stage | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

Euregio Impact Night: Between Vision and Reality

Hosted by: Club Alpbach Südtirol Alto Adige (CASA) & Euregio Tirol-Südtirol-Trentino

Track: Finance

Social entrepreneurs develop business solutions to societal challenges. Founders and experts from the fields of impact investing and innovation promotion will share practical insights into building impact-driven businesses and discuss opportunities and structural challenges in a regional and European context. The discussion will be further explored in the subsequent World Café session.

29.08.2026 08:15 - 29.08.2026 09:00 | Ritual | Mittelschule – Forecourt

Sunrise Bonding

Hosted by: Forum Alpbach Network Committee

Finding a bit of peace and quiet before EFA's vibrant vibes take over.

29.08.2026 08:30 - 29.08.2026 09:00 | Ritual | Church

Into the Silence

A place of calm: Spiritual impulses from various religious and philosophical backgrounds invite you to contemplate and reflect. Inspiring initiators tell their stories, take you on a journey of the mind, and initiate moments of genuine stillness.

29.08.2026 09:00 - 29.08.2026 12:00 | Chat | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

Between Security and Rights: Minority Governance in the Baltic States and Ukraine

Hosted by: Euregio Tirol-Südtirol-Trentino and & Eurac Research

Track: Democracy, Security

Security concerns since 2022 have reshaped how minority issues are governed in the Baltic States and Ukraine. The session brings together regional perspectives to examine these shifts and their policy effects. It identifies risks of securitisation and outlines approaches to balance security and minority rights.

Krivcova, Elizabete: Juristin und Menschenrechtsaktivistin

Paaver, Mari-Liis: Art Historian

Krasnitsky, Alexander: Media Professional

Kascian, Kiryl: Head of the Centre for Communication Influences and Propaganda Research, (Vilnius University)

Keliohlo, Karyna: Employee of the Ukrainian government

Borboly, Csaba: Vice-President of Harghita County Council and member of the European Committee of the Regions

Likhachev, Vyacheslav: Human Rights Activist

Potašenko, Grigorijus: Associate Professor at the Faculty of History (Vilnius University)

Carlà, Andrea: Senior Researcher (Eurac Research Minority Rights Institute)

Rautz, Günther: Eurac Research, Institute for Minority Rights (Eurac Research Minority Rights Institute)

Vasilevich, Hanna: Eurac Research, Institute for Minority Rights (EURAC-Centre for Ethnic and Linguistic Diversity Studies)

29.08.2026 09:00 - 29.08.2026 17:30 | Lab |

Labs: Multi-Day Working Sessions

Track: Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security, Lab

Labs are 3-day facilitated working sessions with a closed and well-selected group of 30 participants that has a joint purpose with the goal that this group, first, becomes a community of action, and second, finds answers to a larger, cross-cutting problem.

Discover the [EFA26 Labs](#).

29.08.2026 09:30 - 29.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Volksschule – Backyard – Classroom 1

From Complexity to Capacity: Policy Design under Volatility and Interdependence

Track: Studio

How can public decisions remain accountable when the conditions around them keep shifting? This Sstudio brings together complexity science, data, models, and concrete EU policy cases. Participants engage with cases from the European Parliament and prototype approaches to test assumptions, uncertainties, and systemic effects before decisions become difficult and costly to revise.

This Studio is organised by nextlearning e. V. and the Complexity Science Hub, in cooperation with the European Parliament.

Reddish, Jenny: Staff Scientist and Lead Editor (Complexity Science Hub & Seshat Global History Databank)

Zsambok, Jakob: Researcher (Complexity Science Hub Vienna)

Sorge, Andreas: Lead Specialist (PD Science Group)

Kondor, Daniel: Postdoctoral Researcher (Complexity Science Hub)

29.08.2026 09:30 - 29.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 2

Is Victory Possible in the 21st Century?

Track: Security, Seminar

What does it mean to win? At what costs may victory be achieved? Are the antagonistic and violent practices and narratives of war and victory reconcilable with a sustainable peace? This seminar critically explores the concept of victory from Antiquity to today and specifically looks at the idea of victory in war. By incorporating moral, political, and cultural considerations, victory in the 21st century is reimaged.

Libiseller, Chiara: Lecturer in Strategic Studies (King's College London)

Bojanic, Petar: Professor of Philosophy (University of Belgrade and RECAS)

29.08.2026 09:30 - 29.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 1

Science and Ethics

Track: Seminar

Can we separate science and ethics? Where do we draw the boundaries?? In Artificial Intelligence, fairness and accountability are inseparable from how systems learn and how they justify knowledge. Scientific choices are moral choices, and ethics depend on scientific assumptions. The seminar explores good scientific practice and scientific misconduct, including falsification and fraud in academic research.

Mitterer, Josef: Professor (University Klagenfurt)

Neges, Katharina: Senior Scientist (Graz University of Technology)

29.08.2026 09:30 - 29.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Handarbeitsraum

Digital Sovereignty: Why Europe Needs It and How It Can Get It

Track: Democracy, Seminar

If digital sovereignty is about the ability to say ‘yes’ to a digital future that aligns with one’s interests and values – and ‘no’ to a future that doesn’t – Europe currently lacks it. In this workshop, we examine why this is the case and why it matters, what can and what should be done about it, and which policies and politics can get Europe there.

Warso, Zuzanna: Director of Research (Open Future Foundation)

Seidl, Timo: Assistant Professor of Political Economy (Technical University of Munich)

29.08.2026 09:30 - 29.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Feuerwehrhaus - Veranstaltungssaal

Hope and the Power to Shape our Future

Track: Seminar

How do we find the will to act when things seem hopeless? Because we are agents who care, our relationship to the future is driven by emotions like hope, anxiety, and despair – not mere feelings, but evaluative states that orient us toward action. Drawing on philosophy and the science of emotion, this interactive seminar invites you to explore how to harness these emotions, individually and collectively, to bring about the futures you value.

Martinez, Camilo: Postdoctoral Researcher (Central European University)

Vazard, Juliette: Senior Researcher (University of Zurich)

29.08.2026 09:30 - 29.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Classroom 5

A New Intergenerational Contract: Whose Future Is It Anyway?

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Our systems are failing future generations, by design, not accident. This seminar confronts uncomfortable truths about power, privilege, and short-termism, asking what it means to act with intergenerational justice in mind. Rooted in scholarship on provoking consciousness and action, the seminar challenges assumptions that keep unjust systems in place. You will leave with a concrete plan to advance justice where you have the greatest influence.

Sallah, Momodou: Executive Director (National Research and Innovation Fund (The Gambia))

Howe, Sophie: Director (Sophie Howe Associates)

29.08.2026 09:30 - 29.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – EDV Room

Carbon Dioxide Removal from the Atmosphere: A Legal Perspective Beyond Net Zero

Track: Climate, Seminar

The world is on track to exceed 1.5 °C of warming. Climate stabilisation depends on both rapidly cutting emissions and removing carbon dioxide from the atmosphere at scale. Removals are therefore an essential climate action, yet often poorly understood. This seminar explores what carbon dioxide removal is and examines the legal challenges and opportunities of net-negative emissions in the EU and beyond.

//INFO: Please make sure to bring your own laptop. If you do not have one, please contact the EFA-Team at seminars@alpbach.org

Köppen, Martje: DPhil Researcher (University of Oxford)

Johnstone, Injy: Senior Research Fellow / Associate (Max Planck Institute for Innovation and Competition / Oxford Net Zero)

29.08.2026 09:30 - 29.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 3

Rethinking AI in Context: Health, Environmental Change and Sustainable Futures

Track: Climate, Seminar

AI is reshaping health systems, environments, and societies, bringing opportunities and risks – but who decides how? Who benefits and who gets left behind? How do we plan for the sustainable use of AI? This interactive seminar equips participants to navigate the key debates around AI governance. Discussing foundational concepts, real-world risks, and governance frameworks, we build towards a shared vision of sustainable, equitable AI futures.

//INFO: Please make sure to bring your own laptop. If you do not have one, please contact the EFA-Team at seminars@alpbach.org

Staunton, Ciara: Experienced Legal and Compliance Expert (BBMRI ERIC)

Amanta, Felippa: PhD candidate and policy researcher (Environmental Change Institute, University of Oxford)

29.08.2026 09:30 - 29.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Your Voice on Wealth: A Citizens' Assembly

Track: Studio

A pioneering Citizens' Assembly brings together young participants to discuss wealth inequality across Europe and beyond. Drawing on high-level expert input and facilitated discussions, participants explore the causes and consequences of extreme wealth concentration and co-create bold, evidence-based solutions for a fairer distribution of wealth, strengthening democracy, social cohesion, and Europe's future.

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Trinh, Nhat An: Sociologist (WZB Berlin Social Science Center)

Alcazar Cid, Marina: Doctoral Researcher and Co-Founder (Paris School of Economics | Club Alpbach Spain | the Wealth Cap Project)

29.08.2026 09:30 - 29.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Gym

Europe Breaks Free: Reconfiguring Dependencies

Track: Security, Seminar

New forms of great power competition are reshaping the dependency calculus of every region. How can the EU and its global partners reconfigure such dependencies in a world shaped by US-China rivalry, Russian aggression, and the transactional dismantling of multilateralism?

The seminar will tackle this question conceptually but also strategically, asking which dependencies to shed and which to deepen, and explore how to pursue genuine interdependence rather than the illusion of full independence.

Bialasiewicz, Luiza: Professor of Political and Economic Geography (Ca' Foscari University of Venice)

Alemanno, Alberto: Jean Monnet Professor of European Law (HEC Paris / The Good Lobby)

29.08.2026 09:30 - 29.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Physikraum

Financial Technology, Geopolitics, and Digital Sovereignty

Track: Finance, Seminar

Financial technologies are reshaping how markets work and citizens access services – while redrawing the balance between public and private power, transforming how money is created, and opening new arenas of competition among states and between states and corporations. How can we ensure sovereignty, data control, and self-determination in this new world? Designed for non-experts, this seminar unpacks what is at stake for society and the world economy.

Georg, Co-Pierre: Professor of Practice in Financial Technology (Frankfurt School of Finance & Management)

Bilotta, Nicola: Senior Research Associate and Coordinator EU-Supervisory Digital Finance Academy / Economist Fellow (Florence School of Banking and Finance - European University Institute / GLOBSEC)

29.08.2026 09:30 - 29.08.2026 12:30 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 4

Geoeconomics and International Trade Policy

Track: Finance, Seminar

The rules-based international order is under pressure: protectionism and the strategic use of economic policy instruments are reshaping global politics and trade. This seminar explores the rise of geo-economics and examines how states use economic tools to pursue political objectives. Participants will discuss the implications for Europe's open and interconnected economy.

Flach, Lisandra: Director and Professor (ifo Center for International Economics and LMU Munich)

Kamin, Katrin: Senior Director Government Affairs, Strategy & Geopolitics (Siemens AG | Kiel Institute for the World Economy)

29.08.2026 14:00 - 29.08.2026 17:30 | Chat | CCA – Heiss-Saal

Euregio Young Researchers Award

Hosted by: Euregio Tirol-Südtirol-Trentino

Track: Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

Young researchers under the age of 35 present their research projects on the topic of strong regions. The aim is to make research from the region more visible and to foster intergenerational dialogue with decisionmakers from academia and politics. A high-level jury selects the award winners, who are honoured in the evening.

Tappeiner, Ulrike: Head of Institute for Alpine Environment at Eurac Research (EURAC-Centre for Ethnic and Linguistic Diversity Studies)

29.08.2026 14:00 - 29.08.2026 17:30 | Stage | CCA – Rogger-Saal

Euregio Innovation Award

Hosted by: Euregio Tirol-Südtirol-Trentino

Track: Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

The Euregio Innovation Award recognises creative products, technologies, and services that strengthen the competitive position of the Euregio Tyrol-South Tyrol-Trentino. Companies from all three regions present their projects. A high-level jury selects the award winners, who are honoured in the evening.

Hofer, Marcus: CEO of the Standortagentur Tirol (Standortagentur Tirol)

29.08.2026 15:00 - 29.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Classroom 5

Dialogue across Divides: Designing Better Conversations for a Polarised World

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Globally, polarisation is rising, yet confrontation isn't inevitable. Constructive dialogue, curiosity over conflict, and finding common ground are choices we can make. This seminar explores the state of division and what it means for society. Through case studies, workshops, and interactive activities, we'll examine the forces shaping political disagreement, and how we can bridge divides to have more productive political conversations.

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McQuone, Rhiannon: Research Associate (More in Common)

MacDonald-Nelson, James: Cities Programme Lead (DemocracyNext)

29.08.2026 15:00 - 29.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Physikraum

Creative Writing: Co-operation, Leadership and Empathy

Track: Art, Seminar

Europe is often treated as geographical entity rather than a community shaped by shared values, such as cooperation, leadership, and empathy. This seminar uses story, poetry, memoir, reflective essays, and collaborative projects to explore ideas of solidarity, responsibility, and belonging across cultures and generations. Participants develop original texts and new perspectives that support dialogue and understanding across borders.

English, Lucy: Professor of Creative Enterprise and The Spoken Word (Bath Spa University)

Jeffries, Lauren: Student (Bath Spa University)

Francis, Daphne: Student (Bath Spa University)

29.08.2026 15:00 - 29.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Volksschule – Backyard – Classroom 1

From Complexity to Capacity: Policy Design under Volatility and Interdependence

Track: Studio

How can public decisions remain accountable when the conditions around them keep shifting? This Studio brings together complexity science, data, models, and concrete EU policy cases. Participants engage with cases from the European Parliament and prototype approaches to test assumptions, uncertainties, and systemic effects before decisions become difficult and costly to revise.

This Studio is organised by nextlearning e. V. and the Complexity Science Hub, in cooperation with the European Parliament.

Sorge, Andreas: Lead Specialist (PD Science Group)

Reddish, Jenny: Staff Scientist and Lead Editor (Complexity Science Hub & Seshat Global History Databank)

Kondor, Daniel: Postdoctoral Researcher (Complexity Science Hub)

Zsambok, Jakob: Researcher (Complexity Science Hub Vienna)

29.08.2026 15:00 - 29.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – Handarbeitsraum

Work Like a Policy Entrepreneur: Turn Moral Ambition into Large Societal Change

Track: Democracy, Seminar

Most people who want to change the world start from a cause they love and a set solution in mind. Policy entrepreneurs ask first: which problem actually needs me and how can I make the most impact? Over five days you learn cause selection, counterfactual thinking, and coalition building, using real cases. You leave with your own theory of change and first steps to make the most impact possible.

//INFO: Please make sure to bring your own laptop. If you do not have one, please contact the EFA-Team at seminars@alpbach.org

Bos, Barend: Head of Democracy Program (The School for Moral Ambition)

van Putten, Jan-Willem: Executive Director (The School for Moral Ambition)

29.08.2026 15:00 - 29.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Feuerwehrhaus – Seminar Room

Perspectives on European Memory: Objects, Stories and Shared Futures

Track: Studio

European memory is shaped by diverse, contradictory perspectives. How can personal memories help connect perspectives and our lives without reducing them to a single story? In this Studio, we will interpret and connect objects/family stories linked to Europe's past to gain new perspectives, link past and present, and co-create narratives that make European memory tangible and relevant for our futures.

//INFO: Please make sure to bring your own laptop. If you do not have one, please contact the EFA-Team at seminars@alpbach.org

Pfister, Jannik: Head of European Identity (Hertie Foundation)

Goslar, Fabian: Founder (Enkel Europas)

29.08.2026 15:00 - 29.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

How Europe Winds

Track: Art, Seminar

Air is essential yet often taken for granted, despite shaping movement, interaction, and perception. The posed question is not How Europe Wins but Winds — like a wind that opens spaces, brings together different voices, and creates new possibilities. Through movement, sound, and collective improvisation, participants are invited to explore ways of expressing themselves artistically. The session culminates in a shared performance, weaving together movement, sound, and expression.

Dorfmeister-Pölzer, Hans-Adrian: Master's Student (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

Madlener, Pia: Student (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

Rademacher, Wiebke: University professor of Music/Arts Education/Head of MA programme (Music and Arts University of the City of Vienna | MUK)

29.08.2026 15:00 - 29.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 4

Stronger Together: The Power of the Ensemble.

Track: Art, Seminar

This seminar will explore the ways in which many individuals can end up working as a cohesive team. Creating an effective and dynamic piece of theatre requires every actor to work seamlessly with the rest of the ensemble regardless of whether their part is major or minor. Acting students from the Royal Academy of Dramatic Art in London will share those parts of their training that enable this important connection.

Shavit, Yael: Senior Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

Schiller, Ingrid: Associate Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

29.08.2026 15:00 - 29.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Feuerwehrhaus - Veranstaltungssaal

Capital in Motion: Understanding How Capital Moves the World

Track: Finance, Seminar

This seminar makes capital markets tangible. Participants act as investors, make decisions under uncertainty, and explore how capital shapes companies and Europe's future. Simulation, expert insights, and discussion connect theory with real-world application.

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Bayer, Daniel: Founder & Consultant (Fingu GmbH)

Lehner, Heike: Economist (independent)

29.08.2026 15:00 - 29.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 3

Theatre as a Sanctuary: How Theatre Builds Confidence and Connection

Track: Art, Seminar

Many actors are introduced to theatre when their parents send them to theatre workshops to overcome their shyness and gain confidence; they end up going on stage in front of hundreds of people. The stage is their place of safety. So, what is it about working together to create a piece of theatre that produces this feeling? This seminar, led by students from the Royal Academy of Dramatic Art in London, will explore this question.

Shavit, Yael: Senior Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

Schiller, Ingrid: Associate Acting Tutor (Royal Academy of Dramatic Arts | RADA)

29.08.2026 15:00 - 29.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – First Floor – EDV Room

Activist Filmmaking: Telling Stories of Resistance and Hope

Track: Art, Seminar

Ecological and social crises dominate the newsfeeds, pushing many people into apathy. How can artistic practices offer a way out? In the seminar, stories of resistance will be explored: Participants will learn about activist filmmaking, engage in dialogue about the narratives we are surrounded by, and create their own piece of hope to empower themselves and others.

Lee, Iara: Activist, Filmmaker, and Cultural Producer (Cultures of Resistance)

Geier, Gerald: Designer, filmmaker, strategist (Open Future Lab, Global Shapers Vienna)

29.08.2026 15:00 - 29.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Gym

Your Voice on Wealth: A Citizens' Assembly

Track: Studio

A pioneering Citizens' Assembly brings together young participants to discuss wealth inequality across Europe and beyond. Drawing on high-level expert input and facilitated discussions, participants explore the causes and consequences of extreme wealth concentration and co-create bold, evidence-based solutions for a fairer distribution of wealth, strengthening democracy, social cohesion, and Europe's future.

Trinh, Nhat An: Sociologist (WZB Berlin Social Science Center)

Alcazar Cid, Marina: Doctoral Researcher and Co-Founder (Paris School of Economics | Club Alpbach Spain | the Wealth Cap Project)

29.08.2026 15:00 - 29.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Ground Floor – Classroom 1

Rewilding Environmental Practices

Track: Art, Seminar

What if the future could be otherwise? This seminar explores imaginative agency through lateral thinking: taking detours, embracing surprise, and making the familiar strange. We will read and discuss texts, walk through the forest, observe, photograph, draw, write, cut, paste, and map. Together, we will create a collective utopian map of futures that do not yet exist - but perhaps could.

Gleim, Meike: Artistic Coordinator and Senior Researcher (Science of Singularities ASBL / Technical University Dortmund)

Ulrich, Antonia: PhD Student, Philosophy (University of Potsdam in coop. with University of Applied Arts Hannover, Design and Media)

29.08.2026 15:00 - 29.08.2026 18:00 | Seminar | Mittelschule – Meadow

OPCON: An Outdoor-based Leadership Seminar

Track: Seminar

Leading people is the ultimate core competence of the military. The action-oriented outdoor peer-to-peer seminar, led by cadets from the Theresian Military Academy Austria, seeks to find answers to the general theme of EFA26, "How Europe wins", under the seminar title "OPCON". In this context, OPCON stands for operational control and is intended to express that a common approach will be needed – while still respecting the sovereignty of the individual actors.

//INFO: The seminar takes place outdoors in all weather conditions. Sportswear and sneakers are recommended.

Gstrein, Alexander: Advisor (Federal Ministry Republic of Austria Defence)

Schiller, Alexander: Staff Officer for Psychological Operations (PsyOps) / Instructor for Communication Trainers (Operations Command Division of the Austrian Armed Forces)

29.08.2026 18:30 - 29.08.2026 20:00 | Stage | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Award Ceremony: Euregio Awards

Hosted by: Euregio Tirol-Südtirol-Trentino

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

In a festive setting, the winners of the Euregio Innovation Award and the Euregio Young Researchers Award are honoured. Afterwards, a get-together invites guests to connect and celebrate.

29.08.2026 19:00 - 29.08.2026 20:00 | Stage | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

Academy Days Closing

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

Join the European Forum Alpbach 2026 Academy Days Closing! Participants from around the world come together to reflect on an inspiring week of Seminars and Studios and to share ideas, insights, and creative outcomes shaped through collaboration across disciplines. Expect a dynamic mix of presentations, performances, and glimpses into the conversations shaping tomorrow's Europe.

29.08.2026 20:00 - 29.08.2026 21:45 | Happening | CCA – Loggia

European Echoes – Celebrate Europe Together

After a week of ideas and debate, it is time to celebrate Europe. The evening begins with an artistic performance leading to the Loggia, followed by remarks, a sunset concert and a curated DJ line-up. Together, we will unfurl a large EU flag and send a message for an open and connected Europe.

//In case of bad weather, the programme will take place in the SPAR Garage.

NENDA: Artist | Musician

29.08.2026 21:00 - 30.08.2026 01:00 | Happening | Spar – Garage

European Echoes – Academy Days Closing Party

Hosted by: Forum Alpbach Network Committee

As the Academy Days come to a close, the SPAR Garage opens for a night of music and connection. With an EU-inspired setting, a DJ line-up and guests from across Europe, celebrate new friendships and everything that connects us.

//Join the Concert at 20:30 at CCA Loggia

//Bring enough cash to pay for drinks. No card payment possible.

30.08.2026 07:30 - 30.08.2026 08:30 | Ritual | Mittelschule – Forecourt

Sunrise Bonding

Hosted by: Forum Alpbach Network Committee

Finding a bit of peace and quiet before EFA's vibrant vibes take over.

30.08.2026 09:00 - 30.08.2026 17:30 | Lab |

Labs: Multi-Day Working Sessions

Track: Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security, Lab

Labs are 3-day facilitated working sessions with a closed and well-selected group of 30 participants that has a joint purpose with the goal that this group, first, becomes a community of action, and second, finds answers to a larger, cross-cutting problem.

Discover the [EFA26 Labs](#).

30.08.2026 09:00 - 30.08.2026 09:45 | Happening | Church

Holy Mass

Join the traditional Church Service at the Alpbach Parish Church to mark the opening of the Tyrol Day.

Hollerich, Jean-Claude: Archbishop of Luxembourg (Archdiocese of Luxembourg)

30.08.2026 10:00 - 30.08.2026 11:00 | Happening | CCA – Square

Ceremonial Welcome and Official Addresses by Political Representatives

Hosted by: Euregio

Official reception with welcome addresses by political representatives of the European Region Tyrol-South Tyrol-Trentino.

30.08.2026 11:00 - 30.08.2026 12:00 | Open Network | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Euregio Summit

Hosted by: Euregio Tirol-Südtirol-Trentino

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

Europe's strength lies in cooperation. The Euregio Summit illustrates how regions and the EU advance innovation through collaboration and secure Europe's long-term competitiveness. The session links regional perspectives with European policymaking and demonstrates how joint action strengthens Europe's capacity to succeed.

Brunner, Magnus: EU Commissioner for Home Affairs and Migration (European Commission)

Tüttö, Kata: President of the European Committee of the Regions

30.08.2026 12:00 - 30.08.2026 15:30 | Happening | CCA - Loggia

Alpbach Welcome

Hosted by: Freiwillige Feuerwehr Alpbach, Bäuerinnen Alpbach, Jungbauernschaft/Landjugend Alpbach, Tourismusverband Alpbach, Gasthof Jakober

A village gathering to celebrate community across cultures: Cross border regions and cultures merge, bringing together residents and international guests of the EFA around food, drinks, as well as traditions from Tirol and Trentino. Join us, take part, and enjoy music, conversation, and the spirit of Alpbach.

30.08.2026 14:00 - 30.08.2026 14:00 | Happening | Volksschule

24 Hours Reading Marathon

Escape the noise of the Alpbach crowds and join us for a literary meditation that will transport you to a different world. Welcome to our yearly 24-hour Reading Marathon. In the Alpbach whirlwind you sometimes just need to wind down a bit. This is your chance to do that by reading "The Magic Mountain" by Thomas Mann collectively between 30 and 31.08. Come whenever you feel like it, read a few pages, pass the book on, and listen to the next chapter.

//INFO: This session begins on 30/08 at 14:00 and ends on 31/08 at 14:00.

30.08.2026 17:00 - 30.08.2026 18:30 | Stage | CCA - Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Opening: Conference Days "How Europe Wins"

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

The Opening of the Conference Days sets the stage for the Forum's central topic: How Europe Wins. It sets out what "winning" means in European terms, advocating for a world of positive sum power politics, fully aware of its limits and determined to thrive in a world it finds, rather than it wishes to be. The discussion frames a European proposition built on being powerful, peaceful and prosperous - and outlines what is at stake if Europe fails to act together.

Karas, Othmar: President (European Forum Alpbach)

Sheikh, Haroon: Professor and senior science advisor to the government of the Netherlands (VU University & WRR)

Tharoor, Shashi: Member and Chairman of the Committee on External Affairs (Indian Parliament)

Ensemble, WAGA: Music ensemble

Pressl, Damita: International moderator & journalist

Letta, Enrico: Dean IE University, Madrid and President Jacques Delors Institute, Paris (IE University and Jacques Delors Institute)

30.08.2026 18:30 - 30.08.2026 20:00 | Happening | Village Square

Be(e) Together - An Invitation from ERSTE Foundation

Track:

A small celebration to share what matters: To round off the Opening of the Conference Days, we're gathering at the 15-metre-long table in the heart of Alpbach - the Forum, the village, and everyone who wants to discuss the changes we truly need. We'll be sharing bread, butter, honey, ideas, and much more; prepared by chefs.

31.08.2026 04:00 - 31.08.2026 09:00 | Hike | Hike Start 1 | CCA Square

Sunrise Hike: Gratspitz

Rise and shine: Enjoy the first rays of sunshine on the top of Alpbach. Experience this special atmosphere and start your day energised!

Plan 4 to 5 hours for the hike, depending on your walking pace.

// INFO: The hike is not recommended for beginners! Attention: 900 metres in ascent! Please wear hiking boots and bring water and possibly a small snack. If you have a head torch, please bring it with you, too. Participation at your own risk!

31.08.2026 07:00 - 31.08.2026 08:00 | Ritual | CCA – Square

Morning Sports: Functional Fitness

Start the day with a boost of energy! The trainers of the Austrian Armed Forces will get you sweating with military functional fitness on the forecourt of the CCA – an ideal way to recover from stress and prevent burnout and illness.

31.08.2026 08:00 - 31.08.2026 08:45 | Chat | Feuerwehrhaus

Morning Briefing

The Morning Briefing will be recorded live: Anna Wallner will speak with Erste Group CEO Peter Bosek for the Die Presse podcast “Was wichtig ist.”

In 2025, Erste Group completed the largest cross-border banking deal in 20 years with its acquisition of Santander Bank Polska, now Erste Bank Polska. We will discuss the deal, why the CEE region is becoming increasingly important for Erste Group and Europe, and where Austria stands. Questions are very much welcome.

Wallner, Anna: Journalist (Die Presse)

Bosek, Peter: CEO (Erste Group)

31.08.2026 09:00 - 31.08.2026 10:00 | Chat | CCA – Hayek-Saal

Book Talk with Franz-Stefan Gady

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

Join Franz-Stefan Gady for a book talk of “Überfall” in the Hayek Hall.

Gady, Franz-Stefan:

31.08.2026 09:00 - 31.08.2026 10:00 | Chat | CCA – Liechtenstein-Saal

In conversation with Andrej Kiska and Carsten Q. Schneider

Track: Democracy

A conversation between Andrej Kiska and Carsten Q. Schneider on the subject of "Lessons from History: Change of Regimes Past and Present".

31.08.2026 09:00 - 31.08.2026 10:00 | Chat | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

Use Your Voice: Decide Which AI Project Best Supports Women Through Financial Education

Track: Finance

Financial education helps women gain independence and access to equal opportunities. In this crowd voting event, MEGA Education Foundation and ERSTE Foundation bring together educational organisations and early-stage EdTech startups to develop AI-driven solutions that make financial education more accessible to women and girls. Help decide which bold ideas will receive funding to scale their impact.

Strolz, Matthias: Impact Entrepreneur & Capacity Builder & Author (TRIQBRIQ AT & Büro Dr. Matthias Strolz - Betrieb für Entfaltung)

31.08.2026 09:00 - 31.08.2026 10:00 | Chat | CCA – Köstler-Einem Saal

Europe's Nuclear Dilemma: Deterrence, Autonomy, and the Future of Security

Hosted by: Club Alpbach Poland with Club Alpbach France

Track: Security

As transatlantic guarantees shift, Europe reassesses nuclear deterrence and strategic autonomy. This session examines emerging security scenarios and asks whether Europe can define its own credible defence posture in an increasingly uncertain geopolitical landscape.

Farfal, Jan: Co-President (Club Alpbach Poland)

Pisarska , Katarzyna: Chair of the Warsaw Security Forum (Casimir Pulaski Foundation)

Ischinger, Wolfgang: Chairman of the Munich Security Conference (Munich Security Conference)

31.08.2026 09:00 - 31.08.2026 10:30 | Chat | CCA – Heiss-Rogger-Saal

Ukraine as Europe's Stress Test

Track: Security

Ukraine has become the environment in which Europe's strategic capacity is tested in real time. This panel explores how choices across security, social cohesion, economic resilience, and democratic governance made in and for Ukraine expose both strengths and limits in current European approaches, and what these lessons could mean for Europe's future.

Mykhalko, Kateryna: Managing Director (New Age Defence)

Hlibovytsky, Yevhen:

Volker, Kurt: Distinguished Fellow (Center for European Policy Analysis)

Zinkanell-Süss, Michael: Director (Austrian Institute for European and Security Policy (AIES))

31.08.2026 09:00 - 31.08.2026 12:00 | Hike | Hike Start 2 | Bus Turning Area

Hike | Efficiency vs Legitimacy: The Trade-Offs of “Cutting Red Tape”

Track: Democracy

Facing growing pressure for faster decisions, many governments turn to “cutting red tape”. Simplifying rules and processes can accelerate procedures, lower burdens, and encourage innovation, but may also weaken oversight, accountability and protection. Scrutinise how institutions and leaders balance these trade-offs between efficiency and legitimacy.

//INFO: Wear sturdy shoes and bring drinking water.

//INFO: In case of heavy rain, the session is going to take place at Volksschule.

Straden, Antonia: Junior Partner/ Board Member/ Outgoing Curator (Peyer Partner Rechtsanwälte/ Club Alpbach Switzerland/ Global Shapers Zurich Hub)

Laschet, Armin: Chair of the Foreign Affairs Committee (German Bundestag)

Pressl, Damita: International moderator & journalist

Alemanno, Alberto: Jean Monnet Professor of European Law (HEC Paris / The Good Lobby)

31.08.2026 09:00 - 31.08.2026 12:00 | Hike | Hike Start 1 | CCA Square

Hike | The Cost of Caution: Risk, Power, and Responsibility

Track: Finance

Europe’s ability to act is shaped by how it handles risk. Incentives often reward caution over initiative, limiting decisive leadership – raising a critical question: can a system designed to avoid failure still produce decisive leadership? This hike examines risk across individual, institutional, and strategic levels, and how systems can shift to enable agency and responsibility.

//INFO: Wear sturdy shoes and bring drinking water.

//INFO: In case of heavy rain, the session is going to take place at CCA-Flora-Saal.

Poletto, Maurizio: Chief Operating Officer and Chief Platform Office (CPO) of Erste Group (Erste Group)

Kaminski, Kilian: Co-Founder (refurbed)

Touzet, Chloé: Policy Lead (SaferAI)

Deutsch, Tina: Co-Founder & Managing Director (KONTEXT Institut)

Fiedler, Susann: Professor of Business Psychology (Vienna University of Economics and Business)

31.08.2026 10:00 - 31.08.2026 12:00 | Work | CCA – Flora-Saal

War, Philanthropy & Civil Society: A Security Architecture Built by People

Track: Democracy, Security

Europe is reshaping its security and defence architecture through unprecedented investment and new strategic priorities. However, civil society and philanthropy remain largely absent from the debate, which has focused primarily on strengthening military capabilities and securing the necessary funding. This session will explore how they can contribute most effectively, where clear boundaries are needed, and how new partnerships and capacity building can strengthen a trans-European understanding of preparedness and societal resilience, effectively contributing towards whole-of-society approaches.

Vohánka, Martin: CEO & Founder (BLIZKSOBE Foundation)

Gady, Franz-Stefan:

Buldioski, Goran:

Ringler, Marie: Vice-President & Global Leadership Group Member (European Forum Alpbach & Ashoka)

31.08.2026 10:30 - 31.08.2026 12:00 | Chat | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

To Be or Not to Be, That Is Europe's Question

Track: Democracy, Security

As geopolitical tensions and economic uncertainty reshape the global order, Europe faces a defining choice: adapt or risk irrelevance. This discussion examines how Europe can reinvent itself, regain its competitiveness, rethink its relationships with the world and build on its distinctive strengths, from democratic values and the rule of law to social innovation, to remain a leading force in the world.

Hauser, Hermann: Co-founder | Venture Partner (Amadeus Capital Partners)

González Laya, Arancha: Dean of the Paris School of International Affairs; former Minister of Foreign Affairs (Sciences Po)

Mair, Johanna: Director (School of Transnational Governance at the European University Institute in Florence)

Treichl, Andreas: CEO (ERSTE Foundation)

31.08.2026 10:30 - 31.08.2026 11:30 | Chat | CCA – Köstler-Einem Saal

Is Inequality Europe's Hidden Vulnerability?

Track: Finance

Viewed through a new lens, wealth concentration emerges as a constraint on growth, trust and political capacity. This session explores how fairer systems could strengthen Europe's ability to act, compete, and sustain long-term ambition.

Disslbacher, Franziska: Economist (Vienna University of Economics and Business)

Ogou Corbi, Viviane:

Ypi, Lea: Professor of Politics and Philosophy (The London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE))

Alcazar Cid, Marina: Doctoral Researcher and Co-Founder (Paris School of Economics | Club Alpbach Spain | the Wealth Cap Project)

31.08.2026 10:30 - 31.08.2026 11:30 | Executive Talk | Hotel Alphof - Dining Hall

Executive Talk: Europe's Defence - More Responsibility, More Capability

Track: Security

Europe's security stands at a turning point. As the transatlantic security architecture comes under increasing pressure, expectations of greater European responsibility for defence are growing. The rapid and comprehensive strengthening of Europe's defence capabilities has therefore become a strategic necessity, including for Austria and Germany. How can this development be supported politically? What role do European cooperation, the removal of existing barriers, and the defence industry play in this process?

Brieger, Robert: Former Chairman of the European Union Military Committee | General (Austrian Federal Army)

Zeller, Jenni: Trainee | Security Track Committee Member (Austrian Ministry of Foreign Affairs | European Forum Alpbach)

Schäfer, Martin: Political Director (Federal Ministry of Defence (Germany))

31.08.2026 10:30 - 31.08.2026 12:00 | Chat | CCA - Liechtenstein-Saal

Who Owns the Truth? Media, AI and Europe's Democratic Future

Track: Democracy

Democracy requires trust. Trust requires credible information. Yet AI, online platforms and economic pressures are fundamentally changing the media landscape. What role can journalism, local media and European institutions play in the future to preserve a shared democratic public sphere?

Wehler-Schoeck, Anja: Member of the Editorial Board (Tagesspiegel)

Bibić, Vedrana: Communications Manager (Faktograf)

Grassegger, Hannes: Founder & CEO (Spatz)

31.08.2026 11:00 - 31.08.2026 14:00 | Happening | Sportanlage Alpbach - Football Field

Football Tournament: The EFA Vienna Derby in Alpbach - Austria vs. Rapid

The football tournament at the European Forum Alpbach is once again a sporting highlight on this year's programme: The legendary Vienna derby between Austria Vienna and Rapid Vienna takes place on the football pitch in Alpbach, with real legends from both clubs.

Also taking part is a high-calibre squad from the worlds of politics, business, science and media.

Come and watch the excitement unfold!

31.08.2026 12:15 - 31.08.2026 13:45 | Track Forum | Gasthof Berghof

Track Forum: Democracy

Track: Democracy

Come and meet fellow participants who share an interest for the Democracy track. Get to know each other at lunch and debate the current programme highlights and main controversies so far.

//INFO: Lunch and drinks are at your own expense. Please be on time at 12:15 so you have enough time to order comfortably. Three dishes are to choose from.

López Domènech, Berta: Policy Analyst on EU enlargement and Western Balkans (European Policy Centre (EPC))

Greubel, Johannes: Head of Programme & Project Lead 'Connecting Europe' (European Policy Centre (EPC))

Saris, Liza: Policy Analyst and Project Manager Connecting Europe (European Policy Centre)

31.08.2026 12:15 - 31.08.2026 13:45 | Open Network | Gasthof Jakober – Dining Hall

WoW* Connects: A Networking Hour for Women*

As part of the EFA [World of Women*](#) initiative, EFA is taking extra efforts to encourage female* contributors, both in programming and participation. Throughout the Conference Days, four sessions of one and a half hours each will be hosted by women* engaged in EFA's broader network, which offers the opportunity to connect, reflect, and act.

// INFO: To ensure a focused and engaging experience, we won't be providing any catering. Participants are, however, free to order lunch and beverages at their own cost.

Ludwig, Bettina: Cultural Anthropologist (Zukunfts.Symposium Eferding)

Bilgin-Kara, Mag. Neslihan: Managing Director (WOMAN World)

31.08.2026 12:30 - 31.08.2026 13:30 | Brown Bag Lunch | CCA – Loggia

Brown Bag Lunch | Weighing Up Anonymity Against Security

To prevent terrorist attacks, security agencies must monitor potential perpetrators. The call by security services and some parties for access to supposedly secure communication channels – so-called messenger surveillance – is causing concern amongst data protection advocates and civil liberties activists. Discuss how a modern democracy should strike this balance.

Dojcsák, Dalma: Executive Director (Hungarian Civil Liberties Union)

Sommavilla, Fabian: Journalist, Der STANDARD

31.08.2026 12:30 - 31.08.2026 13:30 | Chat | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

Solution Hour

Track: Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

The European Forum Alpbach is a place of serious debate; and of the people and initiatives turning ideas into outcomes. The Solution Hour brings forward concrete approaches that are already at work on Europe's pressing challenges: in policy, technology, civil society, and business - less panel, more proof.

31.08.2026 14:00 - 31.08.2026 15:00 | Chat | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

Reimagining Europe's Security Operating System

Track: Security

Europe's sovereignty is tested by geopolitical realignment and rising security pressure. The discussion clarifies what collective defence commitments mean in practice for decisions, responsibilities and operational consequences. It examines how solidarity becomes credible deterrence and how a more self-sustaining European contribution to NATO can work amid shifting US commitment.

Pisarska , Katarzyna: Chair of the Warsaw Security Forum (Casimir Pulaski Foundation)

Groeneveld, Mietta: Director (NATO Command & Control Centre of Excellence)

Wehler-Schoeck, Anja: Member of the Editorial Board (Tagesspiegel)

Welle, Klaus: Chair of the Martens Centre's Academic Council, Special Advisor to the European Defence Commissioner (Martens Centre)

31.08.2026 14:00 - 31.08.2026 15:00 | Chat | CCA – Liechtenstein-Saal

In conversation with

Track:

Schneider, Carsten Q.: Interim President and Rector (Central European University)

Kiska, Andrej: Former President of Slovakia, Entrepreneur & Philanthropist (Good Angel non-profit organization (Dobry Anjel))

31.08.2026 14:00 - 31.08.2026 15:30 | Chat | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Competing in a Changing World - What's Next for Europe?

Track: Democracy, Finance, Security

At a time of profound change, the European Union faces fundamental questions about its future. How can Europe remain competitive, resilient, and capable of acting while responding to new challenges? Which priorities should shape Europe's next chapter? Bringing together four Ministers for European Affairs, this high-level discussion explores the strategic choices that will define the Union's future.

Haddad, Benjamin: Minister Delegate (Ministry for Europe and Foreign Affairs (France))

Pucker, Paula-Marie: Journalist (trend)

Byrne, Thomas: Minister of State for European Affairs and Defence (Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade, Ireland)

Bauer (fmr. Plakolm), Claudia: Federal Minister for Europe, Integration and Family (Republic of Austria)

Niemczycki, Ignacy: Secretary of State for European Affairs (Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Republic of Poland)

31.08.2026 14:00 - 31.08.2026 15:00 | Chat | CCA – Europa Foyer

Migration: Europe's Choices for Humans in Transit

Track: Art

The human costs of European policies: the exhibition “Humans in Transit” on display at the EFA is a storytelling project that documents the perilous journeys of refugees and migrants. It reveals the individual stories behind the statistics and features 310 portraits of people who have fled conflict and shared their stories from detention centers and aboard rescue vessels with Médecins Sans Frontières. During the session, experts and one of the artists will discuss Europe's choices on migration.

Fleming, Melissa: UN Under-Secretary-General for Global Communications

Föderl-Schmid, Alexandra: correspondent (Süddeutsche Zeitung)

Bachmann, Marcus: Advocacy & Humanitarian Affairs Advisor, Médecins Sans Frontières (Médecins Sans Frontières)

Tshibanda, Barly: Artist participant (Artist)

31.08.2026 15:30 - 31.08.2026 17:00 | Chat | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

Vision and Responsibility: Schools in the Age of AI

Track: Democracy

Artificial intelligence is transforming learning, teaching, and school structures, while education systems are grappling with issues of equal opportunities, skills, and regulation. This session highlights fields of action, discusses responsible policy frameworks, and develops approaches for the sustainable integration of AI in schools.

Wasner, Clemens: CEO (enliteAI | AI Austria)

Scheidl, Hannah: Federal Student Representative (HLS Langenlois)

Pichler, Julia: Managing Director (Education Lab)

Gmeiner, Bernhard: Teacher | Keynote Speaker | Author (GRG 15 Auf der Schmelz)

Gabriel, Sonja: Professor for Digital Media Literacy (KPH Vienna/Lower Austria)

Wiederkehr, Christoph: Federal Minister for Education (Austrian Ministry of Education (BMB))

31.08.2026 15:30 - 31.08.2026 17:00 | Chat | CCA – Liechtenstein-Saal

Building the EU's Democratic Resilience for a New Geopolitical Era

Track: Democracy

Safeguarding democracy is no longer a matter of strengthening institutions, but a whole-of-society effort. Despite challenges, the European Union remains the most credible alliance, exercising democratic pluralism at home and multilateralism abroad. At a time of heightened vulnerabilities and democratic threats, the EU needs to develop sustained societal and institutional resilience to withstand shocks and evolve as a global actor. The session will address the strategic choices Europe should make to protect institutions, uphold democracy, and adapt to current and future crises.

Kovač, Nika: Executive Director of D-Hub (D-Hub)

Kazatchkine, Natacha: Secretary General (European Civic Forum)

Dojcsák, Dalma: Executive Director (Hungarian Civil Liberties Union)

Alemanno, Alberto: Jean Monnet Professor of European Law (HEC Paris / The Good Lobby)

31.08.2026 15:30 - 31.08.2026 16:30 | Chat | CCA – Heiss-Rogger-Saal

Building the Capability to Act in Radical Uncertainty

Track: Climate

Taking legitimate, timely decisions on climate risks before societal and political consensus emerge, and as the geopolitical situation becomes more unstable, remains a central challenge. Within the existing window for sovereign action, the discussion explores how to cultivate understanding of and co-existence with non-linear and disruptive change, examining the institutional capacities and social readiness required to act effectively and jointly under radical uncertainty.

Lips, Karen: Deputy Director General (International Institute for Applied Systems Analysis (IIASA))

Lazard, Olivia: Fellow at the Berggruen Institute; Founder at Transition Intelligence (Berggruen Institute; Transition Intelligence)

Sheikh, Haroon: Professor and senior science advisor to the government of the Netherlands (VU University & WRR)

Oroschakoff, Maria Kalina: Journalist | Correspondent (Independent | Neue Zürcher Zeitung)

Thallinger, Günther: Board Member Investment Management & Sustainability (Allianz SE)

31.08.2026 15:30 - 31.08.2026 16:30 | Chat | CCA – Köstler-Einem Saal

Book Talk with Matthias Strolz

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

Join Matthias Strolz for a book talk of “Homo Universus. Unsere Entfaltung in die nächste Stufe der Evolution” in the Köstler-Einem-Hall.

Strolz, Matthias: Impact Entrepreneur & Capacity Builder & Author (TRIQBRIQ AT & Büro Dr. Matthias Strolz - Betrieb für Entfaltung)

31.08.2026 15:30 - 31.08.2026 16:30 | Chat | CCA – Loggia

Cross-Innovation and the Arts: Leveraging the Improbable

Track: Art

The session, developed in collaboration by De Structura, BASIS Vinschgau Venosta and the University of Tartu, explores the intersection of innovation and art. Innovation that stays within a single discipline, drawing on the same skills and the same assumptions, produces incremental results. The real breakthroughs come from collisions between unlike fields, where the arts remain the most underused partner. As AI makes the probable abundant, the improbable, the territory artists are trained to explore, becomes a scarce resource. Be part of this session where we explore the intersection of innovation and art.

Götsch, Hannes: Founder of BASIS Vinschgau Venosta (BASIS Vinschgau Venosta)

Lemberg-Lvova, Anastasia: Director (De Structura)

Lillepalu-Tubli, Pille-Riin: Head of Centre for Creative Entrepreneurship CAMP – Culture Amplified (Tartu University Viljandi Culture Academy)

31.08.2026 15:30 - 31.08.2026 16:30 | Executive Talk | Hotel Alphof – Winter Garden

Executive Talk: The Digital Euro – From Sovereignty to Growth

Track: Finance

Europe's future competitiveness depends not only on advanced technologies, but also on the digital transformation of the service sectors that power the Single Market. The digital euro can provide the trusted public infrastructure to unlock innovation across industries – from tourism and mobility to retail – strengthening the Single Market, empowering SME, fostering consumer trust, and transforming Europe's digital sovereignty into sustainable growth.

Meichenitsch, Josef: Member of the Governing Board (Austrian Central Bank (OeNB))

Niederländer, Petia: Director for Payments, Risk Monitoring and Financial Literacy (Austrian Central Bank (OeNB))

Mei-Pochtler, Antonella: Vice president (European Forum Alpbach)

31.08.2026 17:00 - 31.08.2026 18:30 | Stage | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Capability & Renewal: Mobilising Europe's Power to Act

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

In a world of geopolitical realignment, Europe's "power to act" depends on whether it can translate ambition into capability: deciding faster, building and sustaining effective coalitions under pressure, and delivering security at scale. This session brings together leading foreign policy voices to map the priorities of a European security architecture reconciling different threat perceptions and security traditions.

Theil, Stefan:

Hoxha, Ferit: Minister for Europe and Foreign Affairs (Government of Albania)

Ensemble, RADA:

Herre, Bastian: Politics & Society Lead (Our World in Data)

Bosek, Peter: CEO (Erste Group)

Meinl-Reisinger, Beate: Federal Minister for European and International Affairs (Republic of Austria)

Krastev, Ivan: Albert Hirschman Permanent Fellow (Institute for Human Sciences, IWM Vienna)

31.08.2026 18:30 - 31.08.2026 19:00 | Ritual | Church

Into the Silence

A place of calm: Spiritual impulses from various religious and philosophical backgrounds invite you to contemplate and reflect. Inspiring initiators tell their stories, take you on a journey of the mind, and initiate moments of genuine stillness.

Ypi, Lea: Professor of Politics and Philosophy (The London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE))

31.08.2026 20:30 - 31.08.2026 22:00 | Open Network | Hotel Alphof

Europeans, Believe in Yourselves!

Tyrol welcomes Europe! Join the cosy atmosphere of Alphof for culinary delights: a great opportunity to meet new people and raise a glass together.

01.09.2026 07:00 - 01.09.2026 08:00 | Ritual | CCA – Square

Morning Sports: Functional Fitness

Track:

Start the day with a boost of energy! The trainers of the Austrian Armed Forces will get you sweating with military functional fitness on the forecourt of the CCA – an ideal way to recover from stress and prevent burnout and illness.

01.09.2026 08:00 - 01.09.2026 08:30 | Ritual | Church

Into the Silence

A place of calm: Spiritual impulses from various religious and philosophical backgrounds invite you to contemplate and reflect. Inspiring initiators tell their stories, take you on a journey of the mind, and initiate moments of genuine stillness.

01.09.2026 08:00 - 01.09.2026 08:45 | Chat | Feuerwehrhaus

Morning Briefing | How Europe Can Have Both Climate Action and Growth

The Green Deal has been watered down, geopolitical pressure is growing, and industry complains about a loss of Europe's competitiveness. This Morning Briefing examines the case that Europe does not have to choose between climate action and growth, and asks what it would take for the green transition to deliver quality of life and resilience.

Wagner, Gernot: Climate Economist (Columbia Business School)

Pramer, Philip: Journalist, Der STANDARD

01.09.2026 08:30 - 01.09.2026 12:00 | Hike | Hike Start 3 | CCA Terrace

Hike | We Need to Play a Different Game

Track: Climate

Europe is under pressure: productivity is stagnating, skilled workers are in short supply, and AI and decarbonisation are transforming the economy and the world of work. The session explores the strategy Europe needs to win, which skills will matter, and how high-quality jobs can be secured. The goal: impulses for Europe's next winning moves.

// INFO: Wear hiking shoes and bring drinking water.

// INFO: In case of rain, there is going to be a shuttle to Zirmalm.

Klärner, Patricia: Professor & Director, Institute for Organization Design Vienna University of Economics and Business

Bamberger, Alexander: CEO (BMW Austria)

Köttritsch, Michael:

Suchocki, Oliver: Partner, People Consulting (EY Österreich)

01.09.2026 09:00 - 01.09.2026 12:00 | Hike | Hike Start 2 | Bus Turning Area

Hike | The Benefit-Cost of Stability: Europe's Struggle to Transform

Track: Climate

Europe misprices transformation by treating the status quo as safe while treating change as risky, thus locking capital into systems already in decline. This hike reframes stability as a costly illusion and explores how behavioural bias, cultural habits and incentives distort our decisions. Beyond this, it outlines ways of redirecting capital and engaging institutions proactively toward long-term resilience and transformation.

//INFO: Wear sturdy shoes and bring drinking water.

//INFO: In case of heavy rain, the session is going to take place at Volksschule.

Dunlop, Kirsten: CEO (Climate KIC)

Barth, Jonathan: Senior Associate (Institute for Sustainability Leadership, University of Cambridge)

Deutsch, Tina: Co-Founder & Managing Director (KONTEXT Institut)

van Putten, Jan-Willem: Executive Director (The School for Moral Ambition)

01.09.2026 09:00 - 01.09.2026 10:00 | Chat | CCA – Heiss-Rogger-Saal

How Populism Shapes Europe's Capacity to Commit

Europe's long-term financial commitments, from climate and security to foreign aid and enlargement, depend on political trust that is increasingly contested. This session explores how populist narratives reshape public spending choices and erode institutional credibility. What happens when democratic cycles collide with long-term obligations – and can Europe still honour its commitments?

Bildt, Carl: Co-Chair (ECFR)

Krastev, Ivan: Albert Hirschman Permanent Fellow (Institute for Human Sciences, IWM Vienna)

Sakhno, Hanna: Policy Economist | Board Member (SEO Amsterdam Economics | Club Alpbach Netherlands)

Kovač, Nika: Executive Director of D-Hub (D-Hub)

01.09.2026 09:00 - 01.09.2026 10:00 | Chat | CCA – Liechtenstein-Saal

Book Talk with Oliver Rathkolb

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

Join Oliver Rathkolb for a book talk of “Ökonomie der Angst: Die Rückkehr des nervösen Zeitalters” in the Liechtenstein-Hall.

Rathkolb, Oliver: Chairman of the Board (The Vienna Institute for Cultural and Contemporary History and Arts (VICCA))

01.09.2026 09:00 - 01.09.2026 12:00 | Hike | Hike Start 1 | CCA Square

Hike | Guns, Green, Growth: Europe's Budget Trilemma

Track: Security

Europe faces a budget trilemma: funding security, decarbonisation and competitiveness without breaking trust between member states, sectors, and generations. This hike maps where tradeoffs are unavoidable and where the right priorities can create complementarities through sequencing and fair burden sharing. It distils practical principles for sustaining legitimacy while setting priorities for 2028 to 2034.

//INFO: Wear sturdy shoes and bring drinking water.

//INFO: In case of heavy rain, the session is going to take place at CCA-Flora-Hall.

Clary und Aldringen, Maximilian: Board Member, Chief Retail Officer and COO (Erste Bank)

Wehler-Schoeck, Anja: Member of the Editorial Board (Tagesspiegel)

Lange, Nico: Founder and Director (IRIS Institute for Risk analysis and International Security)

González Laya, Arancha: Dean of the Paris School of International Affairs; former Minister of Foreign Affairs (Sciences Po)

01.09.2026 10:30 - 01.09.2026 11:30 | Chat | CCA – Heiss-Rogger-Saal

Testing Europe's Defences: Are We Prepared for War?

Hosted by: Kyiv Initiative Group Alpbach with Club Alpbach Georgia, Club Alpbach Netherlands, Club Alpbach Switzerland

Track: Security

What does a hybrid conflict on European soil look like? This session addresses Europe's preparedness across defence, infrastructure, and society. Drawing on real-world experiences, it asks where vulnerabilities lie and how Europe can build resilience amid systemic crises.

Brieger, Robert: Former Chairman of the European Union Military Committee | General (Austrian Federal Army)

Scheiwiller, Patrick: President (Club Alpbach Switzerland)

Bloem, Vincent: President/Policy Advisor on Migration (Club Alpbach Netherlands/Tweede Kamer der Staten-Generaal)

Poloz, Maria: President (Kyiv Initiative Group Alpbach)

01.09.2026 10:30 - 01.09.2026 11:30 | Executive Talk | Bikerei 701

Executive Talk: Getting to the Core: From the Comfort Zone to Peak Performance

Track: Democracy

There are many plans to strengthen Europe's competitiveness, yet we often lack the ability to turn them into action. AI is accelerating decisions, processes, and business models, but it cannot replace the people who must step outside their comfort zones. A former chancellor and a medium-sized business entrepreneur discuss how AI is shaping reality—and the standards and ambitions Europe must now set for itself.

Kern, Bettina: Founder | CEO (KERN engineering)

Brunner, Christiane: Board Member (CEOs for Future)

Kern, Christian: CEO (European Locomotive Leasing Group)

01.09.2026 10:30 - 01.09.2026 12:00 | Chat | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

Financing Europe's Future: Competitiveness, Capital Markets, and Economic Policy

Track: Finance

Europe's ambitions in competitiveness, productivity growth, and economic security require substantial private investments. To meet these financing needs, the session explores how deeper capital markets and effective economic policies can unlock investment and channel capital towards strategic priorities. The discussion highlights reforms needed to strengthen Europe's growth potential and resilience.

Faulend, Michael: Vice-Governor (Croatian National Bank (HNB))

Bénassy-Quéré, Agnès: Deputy Governor (Banque de France)

Raposo, Clara: Vice-Governor (Banco de Portugal)

Kocher, Martin: Governor (Austrian Central Bank (OeNB))

01.09.2026 10:30 - 01.09.2026 12:00 | Chat | CCA – Liechtenstein-Saal

Imagining Balkans Futures in 2040

Track: Democracy

Debates on the Balkans tend to focus on diagnosing current crises rather than imagining the futures young people want to live in. Participants project themselves into 2040, articulating scenarios for a region worth staying in and mapping the obstacles ahead. The session produces a shared vision and concrete policy avenues for the long-term transformation of the region.

Beharić, Samir: Programme Manager for Research, Policy, and Advocacy (European Fund for the Balkans)

Blažević, Ivan: Senior Programme Manager for Civic Engagement and Regional Cooperation (European Fund for the Balkans)

Dragičević, Ivana: Founder (Europe Future Centre)

01.09.2026 12:15 - 01.09.2026 13:45 | Open Network | Gasthof Jakober – Dining Hall

WoW* Connects: A Networking Hour for Women*

As part of the EFA [World of Women*](#) initiative, EFA is taking extra efforts to encourage female* contributors, both in programming and participation. Throughout the Conference Days, four sessions of one and a half hours each will be hosted by women* engaged in EFA's broader network, which offers the opportunity to connect, reflect, and act.

// INFO: To ensure a focused and engaging experience, we won't be providing any catering. Participants are, however, free to order lunch and beverages at their own cost.

Fritz, Michaela: Vice Rector for Research and Innovation (Medical University Vienna)

Praeceptor, Beatrix: CEO (Greiner Packaging)

Pisarska , Katarzyna: Chair of the Warsaw Security Forum (Casimir Pulaski Foundation)

01.09.2026 12:15 - 01.09.2026 13:45 | Track Forum | Gasthof Berghof

Track Forum: Climate

Track: Climate

Come and meet fellow participants who share an interest for the Climate track. Get to know each other at lunch and debate the current programme highlights and main controversies so far.

//INFO: Lunch and drinks are at your own expense. Please be on time at 12:15 so you have enough time to order comfortably.

Rogenhofer, Katharina: Managing director (KONTEXT Institut)

Roniger, Johanna: Research Analyst (KONTEXT Institute)

Haas, Sarah: Stakeholder Relations Managerin (KONTEXT Institut)

01.09.2026 12:30 - 01.09.2026 13:30 | Open Network |

Alpbach Pride

Hosted by: IG Wien

The Forum Alpbach Network Pride celebrates its sixth edition! Join the parade and raise your voice against social exclusion. As prejudices and discriminating practices against the LGBTQIA+ community are on the rise in Europe and beyond, it remains necessary to continue this newly established tradition. Feel free to come in your best pride outfit and get the glitter shining for a joint celebration of diversity.

01.09.2026 12:30 - 01.09.2026 13:30 | Chat | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

Solution Hour

Track: Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

The European Forum Alpbach is a place of serious debate; and of the people and initiatives turning ideas into outcomes. The Solution Hour brings forward concrete approaches that are already at work on Europe's pressing challenges: in policy, technology, civil society, and business - less panel, more proof.

01.09.2026 12:30 - 01.09.2026 13:30 | Brown Bag Lunch | CCA – Loggia

Brown Bag Lunch

Join us for an informal discussion format in the EFA Loggia that is exclusively hosted by our Media Partners together with one or two speakers. Be quick - the first participants get a free brown bag lunch!

Milborn, Corinna: Director of Information (ProSiebenSat1Puls4)

01.09.2026 14:00 - 01.09.2026 15:00 | Chat | CCA – Loggia

Artist Talk: Soraya Hossaini

Track: Art

Join artist Soraya Hossaini in conversation with Christoph Thun-Hohenstein, Chair of EFA's Arts & Culture Committee, and Sanjay Sethi, Co-CEO of the Artistic Freedom Initiative, for an engaging discussion on her multidisciplinary artistic practice, her advocacy for women's freedom, and her innovative approach to merging Afghan cultural traditions with contemporary expression in music and fashion.

Hossaini, Soraya: Vocalist & Rubab Player (AFI_Aid A)

Sethi, Sanjay: Co-Executive Director (Artistic Freedom Initiative)

Thun-Hohenstein, Christoph: Artistic Director of the Future Platform ReGenerativa, cultural manager, curator, and author (Future Platform ReGenerativa / Kunst & Klima Werkstaette GmbH)

01.09.2026 14:00 - 01.09.2026 15:00 | Chat | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

Europe's Future: Who Pays and How?

Track: Finance

Europe's approach to long-term investment remains largely crisis-driven, raising broader questions about how its future is financed. This session explores strategies to unlock long-term private capital toward strategic objectives. Discussion will center on the completion of the Capital Markets Union as a means to provide a stable and predictable framework for European investment.

Holzinger-Burgstaller, Gerda: CEO and CFO (Erste Bank Österreich)

Müller-Marbach, Marcel: Senior Regional Representative Austria, Czech Republic and Slovakia (European Investment Fund (EIF))

Sutter, Nikolaus: Head of Government Relations & Political Affairs (Deutsche Börse Group)

Sakhno, Hanna: Policy Economist | Board Member (SEO Amsterdam Economics | Club Alpbach Netherlands)

Deutsch, Tina: Co-Founder & Managing Director (KONTEXT Institut)

01.09.2026 14:00 - 01.09.2026 15:30 | Chat | Hotel Böglerhof – Fichtensaal

How Europe Wins on Housing

Track: Finance

Europe's housing situation has risen to the top of the political agenda, but solutions require coordinated action across sectors. Let's discuss how integrated housing ecosystems can be built, where public, private and philanthropic sector mobilize the capital, capabilities and partnerships needed to secure one of Europe's most fundamental pillars: accessible and affordable housing for all.

KaturiĆ, Ivana: Assistant Professor at the University of Rijeka (UNIRI) and Director of URBANEX (University of Rijeka, URBANEX)

Thurn und Taxis, Philipp: Deputy CEO (ERSTE Foundation)

Edwards, Sorch: General Secretary of Housing Europe (Housing Europe)

Lehmann, Raphael: Impact Investment Manager (ERSTE Foundation)

Urbani, Sergio: CEO (Fondazione Cariplo)

01.09.2026 14:00 - 01.09.2026 15:30 | Chat | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Beyond Bretton Woods: Europe and Asia in the Next Era of Global Finance

Track: Finance

Geopolitical realignment, geoeconomic competition, and interlocking crises are transforming the international financial system. Europe and Asia play a crucial role in shaping a more resilient and inclusive financial architecture. This session explores how development finance, multilateral lending reform and sustainable investment frameworks can create realistic opportunities for cooperation across differing economic models and regulatory systems.

Podobnik, Gerald: Co-Head of Corporate Bank | Member of the Group Management Committee (Deutsche Bank)

Ma, Gene: Chief APAC Representative | Head of China Research (Institute of International Finance (IIF))

Moore, Gyude: Former Minister of Public Works (Ministry of Public Works of Liberia)

Kern, Christian: CEO (European Locomotive Leasing Group)

Xu, Feiyu: University Professor of Industry AI (German University of Digital Science)

Troyjo, Marcos: Former President (New Development Bank)

Porsche, Jovanka: Founder | Chairwoman (Global Neighbours)

01.09.2026 14:00 - 01.09.2026 15:30 | Chat | CCA – Hayek-Saal

Turning Uncertainty into Resilience: Building Future-Ready Businesses

Track: Climate

Global supply chains are increasingly exposed to uncertainty – from geopolitical shifts to climate risks. This session explores how companies can build resilience in practice while creating long-term value. Focusing on concrete examples and cross-sector perspectives, the discussion will examine what works, what can be scaled, and how resilience can be strengthened across the value chain.

Pons, Geneviève: President (Europe Jacques Delors)

Malli, Anita: Head of Environment & Sustainability | Member of the Supervisory Board (ORF | Burgenland Energie)

Wagner, Gernot: Climate Economist (Columbia Business School)

Wälz, Anita: Head of Sustainability | Corporate Communications (Nestlé)

01.09.2026 15:30 - 01.09.2026 16:30 | Executive Talk | Gasthof Berghof

Executive Talk: Delivering Stability in Times of Instability

Track: Finance

Geopolitical developments are reshaping financial markets and government policies, climate change is increasing economic losses, and Europe's digital dependence is exposing additional vulnerabilities. This Executive Talk explores strategic options for action in an era of overlapping and multipolar crises.

Gepp, Joseph: Head of the Business Department (Der Standard)

Balz, Burkhard: Member of the Executive Board (Deutsche Bundesbank)

Pscheidl, Dieter: Head of European Affairs (Vienna Insurance Group)

01.09.2026 15:30 - 01.09.2026 16:30 | Executive Talk | CCA – Heiss-Rogger-Saal

Executive Talk: AI Financial Literacy for a More Trusted Future

Track: Finance

Financial literacy is a prerequisite for democratic participation and economic resilience. Many young people in Europe enter adulthood without essential knowledge of budgeting, compound interest, or basic accounting, contributing to a growing trust deficit in financial institutions and the broader economic system. The session explores how AI-driven learning tools can help close this gap through more accessible and engaging financial education.

Weißebäck, Johannes: Chief Sales Officer (FTG Finance Technologies)

Niederländer, Petia: Director for Payments, Risk Monitoring and Financial Literacy (Austrian Central Bank (OeNB))

Hrebicek, Maximilian: CEO | Founder (FTG Finance Technologies)

01.09.2026 15:30 - 01.09.2026 17:00 | Chat | CCA – Liechtenstein-Saal

Europe's Role in an Era of Geopolitical Upheaval

Track: Security

The international order is eroding. New challenges are emerging for Europe in the form of armed conflicts, shifts in geopolitical power and the end of old certainties. What role can Europe play in this era of geopolitical upheaval? How can existing partnerships be strengthened and new alliances forged to expand Europe's strategic capacity for action?

This panel brings together European and international voices to discuss these questions from different perspectives.

Swoboda , Sebastian: Scientific Advisor (Konrad-Adenauer-Stiftung)

Dhanabalan, Ashwin Immanuel: Doctoral student, Research Associate (Christ University, Hoody Strategy Group)

Zinkanell-Süss, Michael: Director (Austrian Institute for European and Security Policy (AIES))

Clüver Ashbrook, Cathryn: Executive Vice President (Bertelsmann Stiftung)

01.09.2026 15:30 - 01.09.2026 16:30 | Chat | CCA – Köstler-Einem Saal

Book Talk with Arancha González Laya

Join Arancha González Laya for a book talk of "Solos en el mundo" in the Köstler-Einem-Hall.

González Laya, Arancha: Dean of the Paris School of International Affairs; former Minister of Foreign Affairs (Sciences Po)

01.09.2026 15:30 - 01.09.2026 16:30 | Executive Talk | Hotel Post – Seminar Room

Responsible Leadership in Crisis: Executive Talk with Beatrix Praeceptor

Track: Democracy

As geopolitical tensions unsettle societies, the promise of simple answers is gaining ground. Europe's strength depends on another kind of leadership: clear without being authoritarian, decisive without losing humanity, and aware that decisions inside organisations are felt far beyond them, shaping trust, confidence and social resilience.

Pressl, Damita: International moderator & journalist

Praeceptor, Beatrix: CEO (Greiner Packaging)

Fiedler, Susann: Professor of Business Psychology (Vienna University of Economics and Business)

01.09.2026 15:30 - 01.09.2026 16:30 | Chat | CCA – Hayek-Saal

Inequality, Discontent, and a New Social Contract

Track: Democracy, Finance

Rising inequality and growing public discontent are putting pressure on democratic systems and social cohesion. Examine what a new social contract must incorporate to address economic insecurity, demographic challenges, restore trust in institutions, and ensure fair opportunities.

Ostojic, Valentina: Economist & Political Scientist (Club Alpbach Montenegro)

Ringler, Marie: Vice-President & Global Leadership Group Member (European Forum Alpbach & Ashoka)

Rathkolb, Oliver: Chairman of the Board (The Vienna Institute for Cultural and Contemporary History and Arts (VICCA))

Ypi, Lea: Professor of Politics and Philosophy (The London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE))

01.09.2026 16:15 - 01.09.2026 16:45 | Happening | CCA – Europa Foyer

Exhibition Tour: Drawing Lines

Track: Art

Join curator and artist Anastasia Lemberg-Lvova for a tour of the exhibition “Drawing Lines” in the Gallery Room next to the Tourism Office.

Lemberg-Lvova, Anastasia: Director (De Structura)

01.09.2026 17:00 - 01.09.2026 18:30 | Stage | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Finance & Trust: Funding Europe's New Promise

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

The next EU budget will show whether Europe can deliver on climate, security, and competitiveness. With limited resources and rising expectations, choices about what to fund – and what not – are a test of priorities and trust. This session will explore how Europe can allocate its collective resources to strengthen trust between member states, generations, and citizens, and define what Europe stands for.

Ensemble, RADA:

Schloemer, Wiebke: Director of the IFC for the Western Balkans and South Caucasus, Head of Office for IFC Austria (International Finance Corporation)

Herre, Bastian: Politics & Society Lead (Our World in Data)

Wehler-Schoeck, Anja: Member of the Editorial Board (Tagesspiegel)

González Laya, Arancha: Dean of the Paris School of International Affairs; former Minister of Foreign Affairs (Sciences Po)

Mureşan, Siegfried: Member of the European Parliament, Vice Chair of the EPP Group (European Parliament)

Trasi, Cecilia: Senior Policy Advisor (ECCO Climate)

01.09.2026 20:30 - 01.09.2026 21:30 | Happening | Church

Concert: WAGA Ensemble

Track: Art

Join us for a special evening in the enchanting setting of Alpbach's baroque church. Members of WAGA Ensemble, a collective of outstanding young musicians from the University of Music and Performing Arts Graz, will come together in a string quartet formation, joined by a soprano, for a concert that celebrates musical dialogue and offers a glimpse into the ensemble's collaborative spirit and artistic versatility.

//INFO: Limited number of seats available. Please note that drinking from open cups/bottles and eating is not permitted.

Doors: 8.00 pm

Erhart, Kilian:

Maričić, Nikolina:

Majdianfar, Faraz:

Gutiérrez, Itam:

Raab, Cäcilia:

02.09.2026 07:00 - 02.09.2026 08:00 | Ritual | CCA - Square

Morning Sports: Functional Fitness

Start the day with a boost of energy! The trainers of the Austrian Armed Forces will get you sweating with military functional fitness on the forecourt of the CCA - an ideal way to recover from stress and prevent burnout and illness.

02.09.2026 08:00 - 02.09.2026 08:45 | Morning Briefing | Feuerwehrhaus

Morning Briefing

Our Morning Briefings provide a daily overview of the most important news and insights from EFA26. Start your Alpbach day well-informed with an engaging conversation!

Clüver Ashbrook, Cathryn: Executive Vice President (Bertelsmann Stiftung)

Schultheis, Emily: Senior Editorial Director (POLITICO)

02.09.2026 09:00 - 02.09.2026 12:00 | Hike | Hike Start 2 | Bus Turning Area

Hike | Will Artificial Intelligence Create Winners and Losers?

Track: Democracy, Finance

AI is reshaping careers and economic mobility, creating new opportunities while risking unequal access for Europe's younger generation. This hike looks at who benefits and who risks being left behind as AI transforms labor markets. It considers how institutions can ensure inclusive access to opportunity and prevent a new digital divide, ensuring an AI-driven economy that works for all generations.

//INFO: Bring hiking shoes and water.

//INFO: In case of heavy rain, the session is going to take place in the Primary School (ground floor, room 1).

Pucker, Paula-Marie: Journalist (trend)

Crane, Tim: Professor of Philosophy and Pro-Rector (Central European University)

Parvanov, Paulina: Project Lead (Austrian Music Export)

Meierkord, Anja: PIAAC Analyst, Adult Skills Expert (OECD (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development))

Nava, Mario: Director-General DG Employment, Social Affairs and Inclusion (European Commission)

02.09.2026 09:00 - 02.09.2026 10:00 | Chat | Feuerwehrhaus - Veranstaltungssaal

Polarised Youth: Gender, Algorithms, and the Future of Democracy

Hosted by: Club Alpbach Südtirol Alto Adige with Club Alpbach Belgrade, Club Alpbach France, Club Alpbach London, Club Alpbach Montenegro, Club Alpbach Trentino

Track: Democracy

Political divides among young people are widening, shaped by gender, identity, and media ecosystems. This session explores how polarisation is developed, what role algorithms play, and whether democratic dialogue can be rebuilt in increasingly fragmented digital spaces.

Munter, Elisabeth Martina: Scholarship Holder, BSc Student in Physics (Club Alpbach Südtirol Alto Adige (CASA))

Šimić, Lazar: Local Program Assistant (Regional Youth Cooperation Office.)

Saris, Liza: Policy Analyst and Project Manager Connecting Europe (European Policy Centre)

Wiederkehr, Christoph: Federal Minister for Education (Austrian Ministry of Education (BMB))

02.09.2026 09:00 - 02.09.2026 10:00 | Executive Talk | Hotel Alphof – Seminar Room

Executive Talk: Powering the City – From Power Plants to the Future

Track: Climate

The energy system of tomorrow is taking shape today. From modernising power plants and scaling up geothermal energy to adapting regulatory frameworks, cities are becoming the driving force of the energy transition.

Join Wien Energie CEO Sascha Zabransky and State Secretary Elisabeth Zehetner as they discuss the strategic choices, enabling policies and transformative projects that are paving the way toward a sustainable urban energy future.

Zabransky, Sascha: Managing Director (Wien Energie)

Köttritsch, Michael:

Zehetner, Elisabeth: State Secretary (Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs, Energy and Tourism (BMWET))

02.09.2026 09:00 - 02.09.2026 10:30 | Chat | CCA – Heiss-Saal

What Works When Systems Fail: Patterns of Collective Financial Resilience

Track: Finance

Name one system you depend on that you're confident will work in 2040. Pensions? Insurance? Housing? A stable job? This session introduces twelve patterns of collective resilience, each drawn from real cases. Join us to discuss them, remix the systems now failing, and imagine what we could build together instead.

Rigters, Martijn: Designer (Open Future Lab)

Geier, Gerald: Designer, filmmaker, strategist (Open Future Lab, Global Shapers Vienna)

Dovhalonok, Natalia: Designer (Open Future Lab)

02.09.2026 09:00 - 02.09.2026 10:30 | Chat | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Europe's Hidden Strategic Asset: Affordable Medicines

What does it take to build a stronger, more resilient Europe? Secure access to affordable medicines made in Europe is emerging as a cornerstone of economic competitiveness, critical infrastructure resilience, and defense readiness. Marking 20 years of biosimilars in Europe, this session brings together leaders from health, industry, and policy and explores how Europe can transform resilience into a strategic advantage and strengthen its capacity to thrive in an uncertain world.

Baltaci, Köksal: Editor (Die Presse)

Pucci, Marco: Country President (Sandoz Austria)

Ostermann, Herwig: Executive Director (Austrian National Public Health Institute (GÖG))

Schumann, Korinna: Federal Minister (Federal Ministry of Labour, Social Affairs, Health, Care and Consumer Protection (BMASGPK))

02.09.2026 09:00 - 02.09.2026 12:00 | Hike | Hike Start 3 | CCA Terrace

Hike | Jobs in Transition: How Europe's Automotive Industry Secures Its Future

Track: Climate

Decarbonisation, digitalisation, and regulation are putting the industry under pressure. What does this mean for jobs and competitiveness? Will new opportunities emerge – or is Europe facing a structural shift? This session explores how Europe can safeguard employment while preserving its industrial strength.

//INFO: Wear sturdy shoes and bring drinking water.

//INFO: In case of rain, there is going to be a shuttle to Rossmoos.

02.09.2026 09:00 - 02.09.2026 10:00 | ART Event | CCA – Flora-Saal

Book Talk with Cathryn Clüver Ashbrook

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

Join Cathryn Clüver Ashbrook for a book talk of “Der amerikanische Weckruf” in the Flora-Hall.

Clüver Ashbrook, Cathryn: Executive Vice President (Bertelsmann Stiftung)

02.09.2026 09:00 - 02.09.2026 12:00 | Hike | Hike Start 1 | CCA Square

Hike | Data Ownership and Recapturing the Digital Commons

Track: Democracy

As data becomes a key economic and political resource, questions of ownership and control are increasingly urgent. Investigate how societies can reclaim the digital commons, data rights, and create governance models that balance innovation, public interest, safe spaces and democratic accountability.

//INFO: Wear sturdy shoes and bring drinking water.

//INFO: In case of heavy rain, the session is going to take place at CCA-Flora-Hall.

Luksch, Manu: Artist (Chlorophyll arts lab)

Pressl, Damita: International moderator & journalist

Zenner, Kai: Head of Office and Digital Policy Advisor to MEP Axel Voss (European Parliament)

Albrecht, Jan Philipp: President (Heinrich-Böll-Stiftung)

02.09.2026 10:30 - 02.09.2026 11:30 | Executive Talk | Bikerei 701

Executive Talk with Ernst Kloboucnik: Pushing Electromobility Without Spending Tax Money

Track: Climate

The ramp-up of e-mobility is happening too slowly to meet the EU climate targets for the transport sector. To accelerate it, subsidies for the purchase of electric vehicles and the expansion of charging infrastructure are frequently demanded. However, even without distributing taxpayers' money, a decisive policy approach would have substantial instruments at hand to reduce consumer uncertainty.

Kloboucnik, Ernst: Chief Executive Officer (Österreichischer Automobil-, Motorrad- und Touring (ÖAMTC))

Kern, Christian: CEO (European Locomotive Leasing Group)

02.09.2026 10:30 - 02.09.2026 12:00 | Chat | Hotel Böglerhof – Fichtensaal

Powering Prosperity: Energy the decisive lever for Europe`s future

Track: Finance

Sustainability. Affordability. Security of supply. Can Europe have all three? This panel dives into the hard trade-offs of the energy transition – from Austria to Europe to the world – with experts who connect the dots across every scale.

Lamy, Pascal: Chairman (Climate Overshoot Commission)

Oroschakoff, Maria Kalina: Journalist | Correspondent (Independent | Neue Zürcher Zeitung)

Wagner, Gernot: Climate Economist (Columbia Business School)

Malli, Anita: Head of Environment & Sustainability | Member of the Supervisory Board (ORF | Burgenland Energie)

Strugl, Michael: Chief Executive Officer (Verbund)

Hattmannsdorfer, Wolfgang: Federal Minister for Economic Affairs, Energy and Tourism (Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs, Energy and Tourism)

02.09.2026 10:30 - 02.09.2026 11:30 | Chat | Feuerwehrhaus - Veranstaltungssaal

The Politics of the Plate: Global Health and Food Security

Hosted by: Club Alpbach Iraq with FAN Health Initiative, IG Armenia, CA Belgium Brussels, CA London, CA Switzerland, CA Trentino

Track: Climate, Security

Industrial food systems drive climate harm and public health risks – yet remain politically entrenched.

This session examines how subsidies, regulation, and governance failures sustain a system under strain, and asks who holds the power to reform it before its costs become irreversible.

Bittner, Ursula: Organisational Spokesperson and Director of Politics (Greenpeace)

Kowatsch, Bernhard: Director Global Accelerator and Ventures (United Nations World Food Programme)

Hassan, Khalil: Vice President (Club Alpbach Iraq)

Pons, Geneviève: President (Europe Jacques Delors)

02.09.2026 11:00 - 02.09.2026 12:00 | Chat | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

In conversation with Micael Johansson

Track: Finance, Security

A conversation with Micael Johansson on how Europe can build the defence capabilities and industrial strength required to safeguard its sovereignty and ensure both security and prosperity. The discussion will explore what is needed to strengthen Europe's readiness and technological capabilities, how procurement and funding can support industrial development, and how European Union initiatives can strengthen sovereignty in the long term.

Milborn, Corinna: Director of Information (ProSiebenSat1Puls4)

Johansson, Micael: President and CEO (Saab AB)

02.09.2026 12:15 - 02.09.2026 13:45 | Open Network | Gasthof Jakober – Dining Hall

WoW* Connects: A Networking Hour for Women*

As part of the EFA [World of Women*](#) initiative, EFA is taking extra efforts to encourage female* contributors, both in programming and participation. Throughout the Conference Days, four sessions of one and a half hours each will be hosted by women* engaged in EFA's broader network, which offers the opportunity to connect, reflect, and act.

// INFO: To ensure a focused and engaging experience, we won't be providing any catering. Participants are, however, free to order lunch and beverages at their own cost.

Holzleitner, Eva Maria: Federal Minister for Women, Science and Research (Federal Ministry for Women, Science and Research)

02.09.2026 12:15 - 02.09.2026 13:45 | Track Forum | Gasthof Berghof

Track Forum: Security

Track: Security

Come and meet fellow participants who share an interest for the Security track. Get to know each other at lunch and debate the current programme highlights and main controversies so far.

//INFO: Lunch and drinks are at your own expense. Please be on time at 12:15 so you have enough time to order comfortably. Three dishes are to choose from.

Krippner, Friederike: Academy director (Evangelische Akademie zu Berlin)

Kempin, Ronja: Senior Fellow EU/Europe (Stiftung Wissenschaft und Politik (SWP))

Schwarz, Christoph: Senior Research Fellow (Austrian Institute for European and Security Policy)

02.09.2026 12:30 - 02.09.2026 13:30 | Chat | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Solution Hour

Track: Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

The European Forum Alpbach is a place of serious debate; and of the people and initiatives turning ideas into outcomes. The Solution Hour brings forward concrete approaches that are already at work on Europe's pressing challenges: in policy, technology, civil society, and business - less panel, more proof.

02.09.2026 13:00 - 02.09.2026 14:00 | Brown Bag Lunch | CCA - Loggia

Brown Bag Lunch | The Green Deal's Battle over Environmental Rules

Europe's push to simplify regulation is turning the Green Deal into a political battleground between competitiveness and environmental ambition. In this interactive session, participants will examine the politics of the EU's Environmental Omnibus through research and debate its competing priorities. The discussion will clarify the choices shaping future environmental policy.

Dunlop, Kirsten: CEO (Climate KIC)

Rinaldi, Chiara: Intelligence Analyst (POLITICO Europe)

Berger, Frederic: Intelligence Analyst (POLITICO Research & Analysis Division)

02.09.2026 14:00 - 02.09.2026 16:30 | Hike | Hike Start 2 | Bus Turning Area

Hike | A Bunch of (Hidden) Champions - How to Leverage Europe's Strengths

Track: Security

Europe excels at analysing its own weaknesses. But what about its strengths? The continent is home to global market leaders, world-class research, the rule of law, and human rights – set against a rich backdrop of intellectual history, philosophy, and art. This hike explores how these assets can be harnessed to strengthen European resilience and security in the face of geopolitical upheaval.

//INFO: Wear sturdy shoes and bring drinking water.

//INFO: In case of heavy rain, the session is going to take place at Zirmalm.

//INFO: In case of rain, there is going to be a shuttle to Zirmalm.

Quaedvlieg-Mihailović, Sneška: Secretary General (Europa Nostra)

Clüver Ashbrook, Cathryn: Executive Vice President (Bertelsmann Stiftung)

Kammel, Arnold: Secretary General (Austrian Federal Ministry of Defence (BMLV))

Navidi, Sandra: Geschäftsführerin (Beyond Global)

02.09.2026 14:00 - 02.09.2026 16:30 | Hike | Hike Start 3 | CCA Terrace

Hike | Europe's Race for Energy Competitiveness and Resilience

Track: Climate

Europe's energy future depends on fast renewable and grid expansion, affordable power, secure supply chains, and efficient financing. This hike explores building an integrated network, cutting regulatory hurdles, and achieving price stability – asking how renewables boost competitiveness and whether Europe's financial systems enable or restrain long-term industrial resilience. This hike ends near the CCA loggia.

//INFO: Bring hiking shoes and water.

//INFO: In case of heavy rain, the session is going to take place at Volksschule, Klasse 1.

Senk, Gudrun: Technical Managing Director (Wiener Linien)

Zehetner, Elisabeth: State Secretary (Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs, Energy and Tourism (BMWET))

Kreisel, Walter: Serial Entrepreneur | Investor | Founder | CEO (neoom | KREISEL Ventures)

Stühlinger, Lukas: Managing Partner (Fingreen)

König, Richard: CEO (Enery)

02.09.2026 14:00 - 02.09.2026 16:30 | Hike | Hike Start 1 | CCA Square

Hike | Europe's ICE-ban 2035: to Be Confirmed, Softened or Abandoned?

Track: Climate, Finance

Does the fixation on a single technology lead the EU automotive industry into a dead end or into the future? Is it a necessity or bossing Europe's motorists around? The strict 2035 ban of internal combustion engines (ICE) shall now be eased slightly. Is this a sufficient industrial stimulus or merely cosmetics? This is what politicians, member states, carmakers, and climate and consumer watchdogs are arguing about. Hike to the Rossmoos-Hütte; meet up in front of the conference center (CCA).

//INFO: Wear sturdy shoes and bring drinking water.

//INFO: In case of rain, there is going to be a shuttle to Rossmoos.

Wiesinger, Bernhard: Director Consumer & Member Interests (ÖAMTC)

Köppl-Turyna, Monika: Director | President (EcoAustria | European Public Choice Society)

Glawischnig, Eva: CEO | Former Leader (EvaGlawischnigConsulting | The Green Alternative (Austria))

02.09.2026 14:00 - 02.09.2026 15:00 | ART Event | CCA – Hayek-Saal

Artist Talk: Mario Mu

Track: Art

Join Mario Mu for an artist talk about his latest works developed during the ERSTE Foundation's artist in residence programme in the Hayek Hall.

Mu, Mario: Visual Artist and Filmmaker (-)

02.09.2026 14:00 - 02.09.2026 15:30 | Chat | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

Schrödinger's equation: 100 years and none the wiser

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

In 1926, Schrödinger wrote down his famous equation. It has become synonymous with the success story of quantum science and technology - and yet has remained one of the biggest mysteries of modern science.

Mitterer, Josef: Professor (University Klagenfurt)

Aspelmeyer, Markus: Scientific Director (Institute of Quantum Optics and Quantum Information (IQOQI), Austrian Academy of Sciences)

02.09.2026 14:00 - 02.09.2026 15:30 | Chat | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

The Winning Perspective: Mobility Infrastructure as Europe's Backbone

Track: Finance

Europe's economic strength depends on transport systems that function seamlessly across borders. Growing geopolitical uncertainty, climate risks, and increasing mobility demands expose the need for stronger coordination and resilient infrastructure. This session explores how integrated mobility corridors can strengthen competitiveness, improve resilience, and enhance Europe's strategic capacity through closer cross-border cooperation.

Hufnagl, Hartwig: Chief Operating Officer (ASFINAG)

Milborn, Corinna: Director of Information (ProSiebenSat1Puls4)

Hanke, Peter: Federal Minister for Innovation, Mobility and Infrastructure (Republic of Austria)

02.09.2026 14:00 - 02.09.2026 15:00 | Chat | CCA – Liechtenstein-Saal

Acting at Speed: Emergency Measures for Peaceful Ambition

Track: Climate

Europe's transition depends on energy infrastructure deployment at a scale and pace that current systems cannot deliver, hence risking dependence on global actors who can build faster and access resources more readily. In light of current geopolitical developments, this session explores how to align industry, finance, government, and society to deliver the necessary transformation that has the potential to secure Europe's resilience and strategic autonomy.

Harder, Jan Christoph: President Region West | North | Rest of World (RoW) (Škoda Group)

Oroschakoff, Maria Kalina: Journalist | Correspondent (Independent | Neue Zürcher Zeitung)

02.09.2026 14:00 - 02.09.2026 15:30 | Chat | CCA – Köstler-Einem Saal

From Health Data to Better Healthcare | Health Focus

Track: Democracy

Better use of health data could transform healthcare and open new possibilities for research and innovation. With the European Health Data Space (EHDS), the EU is creating a common framework to make this possible across borders. This session explores how to turn this ambition into practice, what implementation requires, and how health data can deliver better outcomes for patients, health systems, and research.

Joller, Karmen: Minister of Social Affairs (Ministry of Social Affairs in Estonia)

Schumann, Korinna: Federal Minister (Federal Ministry of Labour, Social Affairs, Health, Care and Consumer Protection (BMASGPK))

02.09.2026 14:00 - 02.09.2026 15:30 | Chat | Hotel Böglerhof – Fichtensaal

Europe's Role in the Future of Pharmaceutical Innovation | Health Focus

Track: Finance

In the face of current geopolitical developments and recent global upheavals, Europe is under pressure to reassert its position in access to pharmaceutical innovation. The United States is calling clearly for Europe to make an adequate – and therefore greater – contribution. The panel discussion examines this demand from multiple angles: industry, policy and patient advocacy will all have their say, bringing together voices from the US, Europe and Austria.

Baltaci, Köksal: Editor (Die Presse)

Strasser-Weippl, Kathrin: Oncologist and Head | Medical Head (Upper Austria Cancer Center | Austrian Society of Hematology and Medical Oncology (OeGHO))

Kienesberger, Anita: Paediatric Oncology Nurse | Board Member (European Cancer Organisation)

Ostermann, Herwig: Executive Director (Austrian National Public Health Institute (GÖG))

Garcin, Jérôme: Senior Biopharmaceutical Executive | General Manager CH-AT (Bristol Myers Squibb)

02.09.2026 15:30 - 02.09.2026 17:00 | Chat | CCA – Heiss-Rogger-Saal

When Children Take on the Role of Carers: The Unseen Role of Young Caregivers | Health Focus

Track: Democracy

They do the shopping, cook, take their relatives to the doctor, help their siblings, look after them and care for them – all whilst still going to school themselves. Due to their relatives' chronic illnesses, 'young carers' often shoulder heavy responsibilities within their families that go unnoticed. This discussion sheds light on the realities of their lives and offers insights into a growing social alliance dedicated to supporting them – because young carers need all of us to help them shoulder these responsibilities whilst still being able to be children.

Schwabegger, Anna Magdalena: President (Bundesjugendvertretung)

Schumann, Korinna: Federal Minister (Federal Ministry of Labour, Social Affairs, Health, Care and Consumer Protection (BMASGPK))

Pressl, Damita: International moderator & journalist

Nagl-Cupal, Martin: Associate Professor in Nursing Science (University of Vienna)

Traxler, Nicole: Managing Director (Alles Clara GmbH)

02.09.2026 15:30 - 02.09.2026 16:30 | Chat | CCA – Hayek-Saal

In Nobel's Name, For a Nobel Cause? Peace, Prestige, and Moral Authority

Track: Security

Peace is increasingly contested as a concept, shaped by competing interests, digital amplification, and hybrid coercion. The discussion examines Europe's role in defending ethical foundations while navigating prestige politics and rival claims to moral authority. It develops shared language to distinguish credible peace making from performative or instrumentalised narratives.

Pham, Minh-Thu:

Seifert, Thomas: Co-Editor-in-Chief (European Voices)

Krippner, Friederike: Academy director (Evangelische Akademie zu Berlin)

02.09.2026 15:30 - 02.09.2026 16:30 | Executive Talk | Hotel Alphof – Winter Garden

Executive Talk: Rethinking Media Growth, Trust & Scale - Europe's Digital Future

Track: Democracy

Europe's advertising market is growing, yet value creation, data, and control are increasingly shifting towards global platforms. This is weakening the European media landscape and putting innovation, journalistic quality, and digital sovereignty at risk. The key question is: How can Europe secure its digital future? The answer lies in a connected media ecosystem built on trust and impact.

Brandstätter, Helmut: Member of the European Parliament (Renew Europe) (European Parliament)

Vesper, Oliver: Deputy CEO | Chief Digital Officer (CDO) (RTL AdAlliance)

02.09.2026 15:30 - 02.09.2026 17:00 | Chat | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

Water Resilience: Securing the Future of a Precious Resource

Track: Climate

The Alpine region is warming rapidly: extreme weather events and changes in the water cycle are placing increasing pressure on infrastructure, energy, and natural habitats. Water supply is a key issue for the future. This workshop brings together science and practice regarding the impacts of climate change and resilient water systems. What must we do today to ensure security of supply and quality of life tomorrow?

Überreiter, Ernst: Senior Expert on Water Resources (Federal Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry, Regions and Water Management (BMLUK))

Hummer, Katja: Expert on EU Environment and Climate Policy (Federal Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry, Regions and Water Management (BMLUK))

Gruber, Günther: Chief Executive Officer (Silberquelle)

Schmidt, Barbara: Secretary General (Oesterreichs Energie)

Keiler, Margreth: Director of the Institute for Interdisciplinary Mountain Research | Professor of Mountain Research (Institute for Interdisciplinary Mountain Research | University of Innsbruck | University of Inns)

Mörth, Monika: Director General for Water Management (Federal Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry, Regions and Water Management (BMLUK))

Totschnig, Norbert: Federal Minister (Federal Ministry (BMLUK))

02.09.2026 15:30 - 02.09.2026 16:30 | Chat | CCA – Flora-Saal

Book Talk with Yascha Mounk

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

Join Yasha Mounk for a book talk of his upcoming book “The Dispensable Human – Artificial Intelligence and the Collapse of the Middle Class” in the Flora Hall.

Mounk, Yascha: Professor of Practice (Johns Hopkins University)

02.09.2026 15:30 - 02.09.2026 17:00 | Chat | CCA – Liechtenstein-Saal

Change in Motion: Reinventing Industries for Europe’s Future

Track: Finance

Industry leaders are facing profound transformation as legacy business models increasingly diverge from societal expectations, regulatory requirements, and long-term value creation. Curated in collaboration with Philip Morris Austria, this session explores strategies for reinvention, focusing on innovation, sustainable growth, and the role of industry in strengthening Europe’s economic competitiveness.

Malli, Anita: Head of Environment & Sustainability | Member of the Supervisory Board (ORF | Burgenland Energie)

02.09.2026 15:30 - 02.09.2026 17:00 | Chat | Gasthof Berghof

Rebuild with Ukraine: Moving Ambition to Action

Track: Finance, Security

Ukraine's recovery is one of Europe's most important economic transformation opportunities. While political commitment and funding are increasingly available, implementation of projects remains the key challenge. Drawing on first-hand experience, the panel explores how businesses, governments and international institutions can work together to unlock investment, deliver projects, and accelerate the country's long-term transformation.

Mitteregger, Markus: CEO (RAG Austria)

Anzengruber, Wolfgang: Government Coordinator (Ukraine Reconstruction)

Rybchenko, Artem: Deputy Prime Minister (Recovery at the Ministry for Development of Communities and Territories of Ukraine)

Schnabl, Rainer: Executive Board (Raiffeisen Bank International)

02.09.2026 15:30 - 02.09.2026 16:30 | Chat | Hike Start 1 | CCA Square

Art & Third Places: A Stroll through Alpbach Exploring how Art Can Create "Good Places"

Track: Art

Drawing on Harald Welzer's concept of "Good Places", Rainer Prohaska explores the role of artistic practice in their creation. Through an on-site analysis in Alpbach and concrete examples taken from his own work, he examines how art can operate at the intersection of public space, community, and spatial quality. The walk poses the question of how art might serve as an experimental instrument for testing and establishing such places over the long term, and simultaneously acts as an announcement for a more extensive seminar being developed for EFA27. The meeting point is in front of the CCA.

Prohaska, Rainer:

02.09.2026 17:00 - 02.09.2026 18:30 | Stage | CCA - Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Technology & Society: Developing Europe's Next Infrastructure

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

Europe's infrastructure faces pressure from rapid technological change, geopolitical competition, and critical dependencies. Demands for technological, data and energy sovereignty are growing. Debate key bottlenecks and opportunities across systems and governance to identify priorities for a secure, sustainable, and future-ready European infrastructure.

Ensemble, RADA:

Dunlop, Kirsten: CEO (Climate KIC)

Herre, Bastian: Politics & Society Lead (Our World in Data)

Sahl-Corts, Daniel: Managing Director Federal Politics, Head of Berlin Office (VDMA - European Mechanical Engineering Network)

Kern, Christian: CEO (European Locomotive Leasing Group)

Schwarzer, Daniela: President elect (Hertie School)

02.09.2026 18:30 - 02.09.2026 19:00 | Ritual | Church

Into the Silence

A place of calm: Spiritual impulses from various religious and philosophical backgrounds invite you to contemplate and reflect. Inspiring initiators tell their stories, take you on a journey of the mind, and initiate moments of genuine stillness.

Noormandipour-Hart, Lavinia:

02.09.2026 19:00 - 02.09.2026 21:00 | Open Network | Mittelschule – Forecourt

International Bazar

Hosted by: Forum Alpbach Network Committee

No place captures the idea of a global village quite like Alpbach during EFA. With the International Bazar we will further distil this rich tapestry of cultures into a thick spirit, for all to come and sample. Join us as the countries represented at Alpbach show off the very best of their homelands at individual booths. Whether through food, music, or art, we invite you to a journey around the globe without the need to catch a plane.

//INFO: Please feel warmly invited to attend the International Bazar in your traditional clothing. The EFA Code of Conduct needs to be respected.

02.09.2026 20:30 - 02.09.2026 21:30 | Happening | Church

Concert: PPCM- Ensemble

Track: Art

Join us in Alpbach's baroque church for an evening of contemporary and classical music with the PPCM Ensemble. Students of the Performance Practice in Contemporary Music (PPCM) programme at the University of Music and Performing Arts Graz will present a vibrant programme. Enjoy a moment of contemplation and encounter the richness of a contemporary approach to music.

//INFO: Limited number of seats available. Please note that drinking from open cups/bottles and eating is not permitted.

Doors: 8.00 pm

Kochseder, Tobias:

Rainer, Christine:

Primeau, Camille:

Beyers, Laure-Catherine:

Ostojić, Ana:

Jensen-Large, Mikayla:

02.09.2026 20:30 - 02.09.2026 22:00 | Open Network | Hotel Böglerhof – Böglerbar

WOMEN ECONOMIC SUMMIT

Track: Finance

Rules for Action: A Strategy to Reshape Europe's Economy

Leading executives discuss the perspectives of international financial markets, climate policy, the framework of economic law, and industrial corporate governance. What does Europe need to transform regulation from a defensive protective instrument into an active lever for economic strategy and how can a new, confident European vision for the future mobilize investment, spark new economic momentum, and strengthen our capacity to act.

Partner: LeitnerLeitner; Support KONTEXT Institut

Kirchmayr-Schliesselberger, Sabine: Head of the Institute for Finance Law | Professor (LeitnerLeitner | University of Vienna)

Milborn, Corinna: Director of Information (ProSiebenSat1Puls4)

Holzleitner, Eva Maria: Federal Minister for Women, Science and Research (Federal Ministry for Women, Science and Research)

Gruszkiewicz, Barbara: Director Strategy and Corporate Affairs (LeitnerLeitner)

Rogenhofer, Katharina: Managing director (KONTEXT Institut)

Fassl, Lisa-Marie: Managing Partner (Fund F)

Deutsch, Tina: Co-Founder & Managing Director (KONTEXT Institut)

03.09.2026 07:00 - 03.09.2026 08:00 | Ritual | CCA – Square

Morning Sports: Functional Fitness

Start the day with a boost of energy! The trainers of the Austrian Armed Forces will get you sweating with military functional fitness on the forecourt of the CCA – an ideal way to recover from stress and prevent burnout and illness.

03.09.2026 08:00 - 03.09.2026 08:30 | Ritual | Church

Into the Silence

A place of calm: Spiritual impulses from various religious and philosophical backgrounds invite you to contemplate and reflect. Inspiring initiators tell their stories, take you on a journey of the mind and initiate moments of genuine stillness.

Krippner, Friederike: Academy director (Evangelische Akademie zu Berlin)

03.09.2026 08:00 - 03.09.2026 08:45 | Morning Briefing | Feuerwehrhaus

Morning Briefing

Our Morning Briefings provide a daily overview of the most important news and insights from EFA26. Start your Alpbach day well-informed with an engaging conversation!

Fintelmann, Julius E. O.: Editor-in-chief (The European Correspondent)

Schwarzer, Daniela: President elect (Hertie School)

03.09.2026 09:00 - 03.09.2026 12:00 | Hike | Hike Start 2 | Bus Turning Area

Hike | Europe's Diplomatic Counter-Revolution: Alliances and Deal Craft

Track: Security

In a world where power politics and “might makes right” are gaining ground, reliability is hard currency. Europe's comparative advantage lies in credible, rules-based influence and the ability to convene coalitions with like-minded partners. This Hike explores how Europe can shape change in the international system through partnerships forged by shared interests and diplomatic dealcraft. It highlights how reinforcing trust and stability can translate into sustained European soft power.

//INFO: Wear sturdy shoes and bring drinking water.

//INFO: In case of heavy rain, the session is going to take place at the Firestation Event Hall

Mayr-Harting, Thomas: Director (EU Diplomatic Academy)

Stagno Ugarte, Bruno: Chief Advocacy Officer (Human Rights Watch)

Farfal, Jan: Co-President (Club Alpbach Poland)

Schreinemacher, Liesje: Deputy Secretary-General (Benelux Union)

03.09.2026 09:00 - 03.09.2026 12:00 | Hike | Hike Start 1 | CCA Square

Hike | Regenerative Sovereignty: How Might Europe Thrive

Track: Climate

Europe's sovereignty remains tied to external dependencies on resources and extraction-based systems, limiting its own capacity to thrive and adapt sustainably. This hike looks at the meaning of regenerative sovereignty: how prosperity can be redefined through circular, nature-based systems that strengthen domestic capabilities and provide long-term security. Can Europe become the first continent to define its power by how much it restores rather than how much it extracts?

//INFO: Wear sturdy shoes and bring drinking water.

//INFO: In case of heavy rain, the session is going to take place at CCA at Köstler-Einem Hall.

Swinson, Jo: Director (Partners for a New Economy)

Haddaway, Neal: Photojournalist and Researcher (Freelance)

Damhof, Loes: UNESCO Chair for Futures Literacy in Higher Education (Hanze University of Applied Sciences)

Haas, Sarah: Stakeholder Relations Managerin (KONTEXT Institut)

03.09.2026 09:00 - 03.09.2026 12:00 | Hike | Hike Start 3 | CCA Terrace

Hike | Industrial Sovereignty in European Procurement

Track: Climate, Finance, Security

Public procurement across Europe still favours lowest cost, while competitors abroad protect their own industrial base. This hike asks whether EU procurement rules still fit a changing geopolitical reality, weighing open markets against industrial sovereignty and resilient supply chains, and discusses how to strengthen 'Made in Europe' while remaining competitive.

//INFO: Wear sturdy shoes and bring drinking water.

//INFO: In case of rain, there is going to be a shuttle to Rossmoos.

Roháč, Dalibor: Advisor (GLOBSEC)

Köppl-Turyna, Monika: Director | President (EcoAustria | European Public Choice Society)

Zsifkovits, Martin: Managing Director (Škoda Group Austria)

Harder, Jan Christoph: President Region West | North | Rest of World (RoW) (Škoda Group)

Hattmannsdorfer, Wolfgang: Federal Minister for Economic Affairs, Energy and Tourism (Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs, Energy and Tourism)

03.09.2026 09:00 - 03.09.2026 10:00 | Chat | CCA – Hayek-Saal

Book Talk with Lea Ypi

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

Join Lea Ypi for a book talk of “Indignity: A Life Reimagined” in the Hayek Hall.

Ypi, Lea: Professor of Politics and Philosophy (The London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE))

03.09.2026 09:00 - 03.09.2026 12:00 | Hike | CCA – Loggia

Hike | Converging Crises, Shared Responses: Can Europe and Asia Find Common Ground?

Track: Finance

Climate change, food insecurity, public health fragility, geopolitical conflict, and widening inequality are systematic global crises, cutting across national borders and political systems. Yet, responses to them remain fragmented. For Europe and Asia, these challenges create both friction and opportunity. This session explores how interlocking crises can serve as a basis for alignment, identifying common ground and realistic entry points for joint, sustainable action.

//INFO: Wear sturdy shoes and bring drinking water.

//INFO: In case of heavy rain, the session is going to take place at CCA – Köstler-Einem Saal.

Chatterjee, Siddharth: Chief Executive Officer (Global Neighbours)

Norov, Vladimir: Former Foreign Minister (Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Uzbekistan)

Rösler, Philipp: Secretary General (Global Neighbours)

03.09.2026 09:00 - 03.09.2026 10:30 | Chat | CCA – Flora-Saal

Europe's Energy Resilience: Sovereignty, Interconnection, and Transition

Track: Climate, Finance

As Europe redefines its energy map, Southeast Europe has emerged as a vital gateway for the continent's security and supply diversification. Discuss how regional interconnections, infrastructure expansion, and green transition initiatives contribute to broader European energy resilience. The session will highlight how solidarity and cross-border alignment in the region serve as a shield against global market shocks for the entire European Union.

Herlitschka, Sabine: CEO (Infineon Technologies Austria)

Peshov, Kalin: Chairman of the Management Board (Glavbolgarstroy (GBS))

Tsakiris, Ioannis: Vice-President (European Investment Bank)

Tsomokos, Symeon: Founder & President (Delphi Economic Forum)

03.09.2026 10:30 - 03.09.2026 11:30 | Chat | CCA – Heiss-Rogger-Saal

Security without Trust: Democracy in Times of Fear

Hosted by: Club Alpbach Georgia with Club Alpbach Iraq, Club Alpbach Salzburg, FAN Democracy Initiative

Track: Democracy, Security

As security pressures rise, democratic trust is tested. This session examines how crisis-driven governance reshapes institutional legitimacy. It also asks how Europe can maintain both effectiveness and accountability when fear redefines political decision-making, identifying concrete mechanisms to sustain public confidence during geopolitical uncertainty.

Schwarz, Christoph: Senior Research Fellow (Austrian Institute for European and Security Policy)

Schwarzer, Daniela: President elect (Hertie School)

Iantbelidze, Erekle: Board Member (Club Alpbach Georgia)

Zeller, Jenni: Trainee | Security Track Committee Member (Austrian Ministry of Foreign Affairs | European Forum Alpbach)

03.09.2026 10:30 - 03.09.2026 11:30 | Executive Talk | Bikerei 701

An Executive Pitch for a Strong Europe

Track: Finance

We are shaping the future of business! But how? Based on a survey of 450 female executives, we explore the key questions: Competitiveness: How can we unleash it again by reducing bureaucracy and regulation? AI, Digitalisation & Cybersecurity: How can these topics drive growth, efficiency, and innovation? Societal Mindset: Which patterns of thinking will we need to break?

Ringler, Marie: Vice-President & Global Leadership Group Member (European Forum Alpbach & Ashoka)

Fanto, Karen: CEO / Director International Markets (Zukunft.Frauen Alumnae Club / Berndorf Bäderbau)

Perfahl-Strilka, Jutta: CEO / Vice Chair (Hokify / Zukunft.Frauen Alumnae Club)

03.09.2026 10:30 - 03.09.2026 12:00 | Chat | CCA – Liechtenstein-Saal

Shaping the Future of Healthcare – Hospitals and Primary Care | Health Focus

Track: Democracy

How should healthcare be organised in the future? As healthcare systems face growing pressure, this session explores the evolving roles of hospitals, primary care and other health professionals in addressing workforce shortages, rising demand and the transformation of care structures. It also examines how the European Health Data Space can support more integrated, data-driven and patient-centred healthcare.

Schumann, Korinna: Federal Minister (Federal Ministry of Labour, Social Affairs, Health, Care and Consumer Protection (BMASGPK))

Fritz, Michaela: Vice Rector for Research and Innovation (Medical University Vienna)

Steinhart, Johannes: President (Austrian Medical Chamber | Vienna Medical Chamber)

03.09.2026 12:15 - 03.09.2026 13:45 | Open Network | Gasthof Jakober – Dining Hall

WoW* Connects: A Networking Hour for Women*

As part of the EFA [World of Women*](#) initiative, EFA is taking extra efforts to encourage female* contributors, both in programming and participation. Throughout the Conference Days, four sessions of one and a half hours each will be hosted by women* engaged in EFA's broader network, which offers the opportunity to connect, reflect, and act.

// INFO: To ensure a focused and engaging experience, we won't be providing any catering. Participants are, however, free to order lunch and beverages at their own cost.

Dixson-Declève, Sandrine: Executive Chair (Earth4all)

Holzleitner, Eva Maria: Federal Minister for Women, Science and Research (Federal Ministry for Women, Science and Research)

03.09.2026 12:15 - 03.09.2026 13:45 | Track Forum | Gasthof Berghof

Track Forum: Finance

Track: Finance

Come and meet fellow participants who share an interest for the Finance track. Get to know each other at lunch and debate the current programme highlights and main controversies so far.

//INFO: Lunch and drinks are at your own expense. Please be on time at 12:15 so you have enough time to order comfortably. Three dishes are to choose from.

Greppi, Costanza: Economic Research Analyst (Bruegel, European economic think tank)

03.09.2026 12:30 - 03.09.2026 13:30 | Chat | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Solution Hour

Track: Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

The European Forum Alpbach is a place of serious debate; and of the people and initiatives turning ideas into outcomes. The Solution Hour brings forward concrete approaches that are already at work on Europe's pressing challenges: in policy, technology, civil society, and business - less panel, more proof.

03.09.2026 12:30 - 03.09.2026 13:30 | Brown Bag Lunch | CCA – Loggia

Brown Bag Lunch | How Europe Stands to Gain from Tackling the Climate Crisis

Recent geopolitical upheavals show that Europe's dependence on fossil fuels is not only a climate and security risk, but also an economic vulnerability. The global race for clean energy and green technologies is in full swing. This discussion brings up the questions of which countries stand to benefit, which are falling behind – and how the EU should respond to the US.

Pucker, Paula-Marie: Journalist (trend)

Wagner, Gernot: Climate Economist (Columbia Business School)

03.09.2026 14:00 - 03.09.2026 15:00 | Chat | CCA – Loggia

Dialogue in Motion: Culture as a Soft Power

Track: Art

In this final session of the cooperation between EFA, Stiftung Zukunft Berlin, and the Charlemagne Prize Foundation, participants will discuss the essential role of art and culture in shaping Europe's soft power. The conversation will explore how cultural exchange, artistic freedom, and creative collaboration help promote European values, strengthen international dialogue, and enhance Europe's influence in an increasingly complex global landscape.

Kalesnikava, Maria: Belarusian civil rights leader and recipient of the Charlemagne Prize

Knoch, Christophe: Board Member of Stiftung Zukunft, Moderator and Connector (Stiftung Zukunft Berlin)

Parvanov, Paulina: Project Lead (Austrian Music Export)

Kneip, Winfried: Founder and Programm Director (Love Politics)

03.09.2026 14:00 - 03.09.2026 15:30 | Chat | Hotel Böglerhof – Fichtensaal

Security for Whom? Europe's Race for Rare Earth and the Human Cost in Myanmar

Track: Climate, Security

Europe's race for rare earth elements – critical for the green and digital transition as well as the defense sector – rests on supply chains linked to conflict, environmental destruction, and human insecurity, as seen in Myanmar. This session examines the upstream realities of rare earth extraction and seeks to identify pathways towards supply chain governance that are committed to upholding human dignity for all.

Stagno Ugarte, Bruno: Chief Advocacy Officer (Human Rights Watch)

Lwi, Hkaw: Executive Director (BRIDGE Myanmar)

Zhou, Jiayi: Senior Researcher (Stockholm International Peace Research Institute)

Reinold, Florian: Director Southeast Asia Regional Office (Heinrich-Böll-Stiftung e.V.)

03.09.2026 14:00 - 03.09.2026 15:00 | Chat | CCA – Heiss-Rogger-Saal

The Democratic Comeback: How the Rule of Law Wins

Track: Democracy

Across many countries, illiberal governments have weakened checks and balances, undermined judicial independence, and eroded public trust. Explore the prospects for reversing illiberal trends and restoring the rule of law in systems under strain that can fuel a broader democratic comeback.

Pomaska, Agnieszka: Member of Polish Parliament (Sejm of the Republic of Poland)

Szigeti, Flóra: Senior Advisor | Manager of Leadership Programs (DemNet | CEU Democracy Institute)

Pressl, Damita: International moderator & journalist

Mounk, Yascha: Professor of Practice (Johns Hopkins University)

03.09.2026 15:30 - 03.09.2026 16:30 | Chat | CCA – Hayek-Saal

The Moral Economy: Financing Europe's Welfare State

Track: Democracy, Finance

Europe's public finances are increasingly under strain from demographic ageing, inequality, and structural economic transformation. The session discusses the future of the welfare state in an era of growing scarcity and systemic change. It focuses on fiscal sustainability, the distribution of financial burdens between the state, markets, and individuals, and the conditions needed to maintain social cohesion in a period of rapid transformation.

Ypi, Lea: Professor of Politics and Philosophy (The London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE))

Upis, Guntars: Economist & Research Analyst (PwC Netherlands Chief Economist Office)

Meierkord, Anja: PIAAC Analyst, Adult Skills Expert (OECD (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development))

03.09.2026 16:15 - 03.09.2026 16:45 | Happening | CCA – Europa Foyer

Exhibition Tour: Drawing Lines

Track: Art

Join curator and artist Anastasia Lemberg-Lvova for a tour of the exhibition “Drawing Lines” in the Gallery Room next to the Tourism Office.

Lemberg-Lvova, Anastasia: Director (De Structura)

03.09.2026 17:00 - 03.09.2026 18:30 | Stage | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Envisioning the Europe We Build

Track: Art, Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

The global order is being rewritten: By force, by markets, by technology, and by the sheer ambition of other civilisational projects. Europe's response cannot be to imitate any of them. Europe's strength lies elsewhere: in the deliberate, conscious choice to build a civilisational model on its own terms. Its future is based on self-efficacy - how does Europe foster its capacity to act from conviction, determined that its choices matter, and how does it cultivate the institutional and intellectual readiness to make them?

Ensemble, RADA:

Kalesnikava, Maria: Belarusian civil rights leader and recipient of the Charlemagne Prize

Herre, Bastian: Politics & Society Lead (Our World in Data)

Dixson-Declève, Sandrine: Executive Chair (Earth4all)

Chatterjee, Siddharth: Chief Executive Officer (Global Neighbours)

03.09.2026 19:00 - 03.09.2026 20:00 | Happening | CCA – Loggia

Sunset Concert with Soraya Hossaini

Track: Art

Join Soraya Hossaini for an intimate concert on the Loggia, set against the breathtaking backdrop of Alpbach and its surrounding mountains. Experience the rich and captivating sounds of Afghan traditional music performed on the rubab, Afghanistan's national instrument. Through a unique interplay of traditional melodies and contemporary harmonies and rhythms, this concert offers a vibrant musical journey that bridges cultural heritage and modern artistic expression.

Hossaini, Soraya: Vocalist & Rubab Player (AFI_Aid A)

03.09.2026 20:00 - 03.09.2026 22:00 | Stage | CCA – Herz-Kremenak-Saal

Annual Speakers Night & Farewell Party

Hosted by: Club Alpbach Styria

Speakers Night is the popular public speaking contest; a platform for scholarship holders to showcase their rhetorical skills on the big stage. The format offers a selected group of bright young minds the ideal opportunity to share their ideas and perspectives on a pre-determined topic with a larger audience, all while receiving valuable feedback from a distinguished panel.

04.09.2026 07:00 - 04.09.2026 08:00 | Ritual | CCA – Square

Morning Sports: Functional Fitness

Start the day with a boost of energy! The trainers of the Austrian Armed Forces will get you sweating with military functional fitness on the forecourt of the CCA – an ideal way to recover from stress and prevent burnout and illness.

04.09.2026 08:00 - 04.09.2026 08:45 | Chat | Feuerwehrhaus

Morning Briefing

Our Morning Briefings provide a daily overview of the most important news and insights from EFA26. Start your Alpbach day well-informed with an engaging conversation!

Lentsch, Josef:

Grassl, Andreas:

04.09.2026 08:00 - 04.09.2026 08:30 | Ritual | Church

Into the Silence

A place of calm: Spiritual impulses from various religious and philosophical backgrounds invite you to contemplate and reflect. Inspiring initiators tell their stories, take you on a journey of the mind, and initiate moments of genuine stillness.

04.09.2026 10:00 - 04.09.2026 12:30 | Stage | CCA – Schrödinger-Saal

EFA26: Call to Action

Track: Climate, Democracy, Finance, Security

Every generation tells Europe differently but rarely to each other. As the Forum draws to a close, we turn on Europe's next grand story - and who gets to tell it. Building on insights and debates from the past two weeks, all present generations, current and future decision-makers, enter into a focused intergenerational exchange. They reflect on recently gained perspectives and, in a co-creative process, distill key impulses to define concrete steps for the period following the Forum, resulting in an intergenerational manifesto.

Ensemble, PPCM: